

April 2024



Houlihan
Lokey

2023 Going Private Transaction Study



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01

STUDY OVERVIEW

Introduction

- In the 2023 Going Private Transaction Study (the “Study”), we have summarized and analyzed 33 going private transactions announced in the calendar year ended December 31, 2023.
- As of the date of this Study, 30 of the going private transactions have closed and three are pending closing.
- For purposes of this Study, a target company is generally considered to have “gone private” if its pre-transaction publicly traded shares were purchased by a privately held financial sponsor, investment company, or similar entity (generically referred to as a “financial buyer”), typically in a leveraged buyout transaction.
- Specifically, this Study analyzes the following items for each of the 33 transactions:
 - Transaction background, focusing on management, stockholder, and board involvement;
 - Transaction valuation (including transaction multiples and acquisition premiums);
 - Deal protection measures and fiduciary provisions;
 - Transaction structure and financing; and
 - Termination provisions.

The Study was authored by Richard De Rose, Matt Kavney, and Gretta Conrath of Houlihan Lokey's New York, Atlanta, and Chicago offices, respectively. If you have any questions or comments, please contact Mr. De Rose at +1 212.497.7867, Mr. Kavney at +1 404.495.7030, or Ms. Conrath at +1 312.462.6407. We would also like to recognize contributions from Neha Shah, Kobby Quyenortey, and Kyle Poorman of Houlihan Lokey's New York office in the preparation of the Study.



Definition of Key Items in the Study

- We used the following methodology to analyze each of the transactions:
 - **Transaction Value:** We calculated transaction value (TV) using data from S&P Capital IQ. TV represents the cost to acquire all common equity, preferred equity, and convertible securities, plus the face value of all outstanding debt, less cash and marketable securities.
 - **Valuation Multiples:** The valuation multiples include TV/Revenue, TV/EBITDA, and TV/EBIT. We derived Revenue, EBITDA, and EBIT figures from S&P Capital IQ as of the latest 12-month (LTM) period prior to announcement.
 - **Acquisition Premiums:** We obtained acquisition premiums from S&P Capital IQ. These premiums are calculated by measuring the percentage change from the offer price per share to the trading prices one day, one week, and one month prior to the transaction announcement date. When there was public disclosure of an auction process prior to signing the agreement, the acquisition premiums were calculated based on the unaffected stock price.
- Note: When analyzing the acquisition premiums, we excluded negative premiums from our high, low, median, and mean calculations, as these transactions involved companies in special or unusual situations and were not considered to be representative of going private acquisition premiums.

Transaction Screening Methodology

- We identified the potential universe of going private transactions through several screens from widely used transaction databases, including LSEG (formerly Refinitiv) and S&P Capital IQ, as well as by reviewing transactions requiring a Schedule 13E-3 filing with the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC).
- For this Study, we excluded transactions with the following characteristics:
 - Transactions involving target companies that have their primary business operations outside of the United States;
 - Transactions involving targets with an implied enterprise value under \$50 million;
 - Transactions for which there was insufficient information regarding terms (generally, smaller transactions);
 - “Going-dark” transactions, in which a publicly traded company reduces the number of stockholders of record below a certain threshold (often through reverse stock splits and share repurchases) to avoid SEC filing requirements;
 - Transactions involving a privately held, nonfinancial (i.e., strategic) buyer;
 - Transactions involving bankrupt, reorganizing, or distressed target companies; and
 - Transactions that were canceled or withdrawn prior to the execution of a merger agreement.

02 SELECTED MARKET OBSERVATIONS

Going Private Transactions

Houlihan Lokey Observations

- The number of sponsor-backed going private transactions decreased from 45 transactions in 2022 to 33 transactions in 2023, and continues to be elevated relative to historical activity levels.
 - Transaction values in 2023 were considerably lower than transaction values in 2022, with average transaction values of \$6.0 billion and \$2.6 billion observed in 2022 and 2023, respectively.
 - The number of deals with transaction values above \$10.0 billion decreased from eight in 2022 to one in 2023, as major strategic players focused efforts on profitability and roll-up or other inorganic growth strategies.
- The median LTM EBITDA multiple decreased from 16.8x in 2022 to 12.8x in 2023, and the median one-day acquisition premium increased from 34.0% in 2022 to 46.3% in 2023.
- The use of auctions remains prevalent, though there was a notable uptick in the use of widespread auctions and public disclosure of the auction prior to transaction signing.
 - Of the 32 transactions that featured an auction in 2023, 22 (69%) utilized a widespread auction process, where more than 15 prospective buyers were solicited, representing a meaningful increase from 38% in 2022, when sales processes were much more targeted.
- In 2023, 13 (39%) of the sponsor-backed transactions were club deals involving two or more sponsors, compared to only 27% in 2022, as sponsors seek to fund transactions and fill debt financing gaps.
- The delivery of both debt and equity commitment letters upon signing decreased meaningfully, from 73% in 2022 down to 45% in 2023; however, the percentage of financial sponsors guaranteeing reverse termination fees, if present, increased from 78% in 2022 to 88% in 2023.
 - In 2023, there was a notable decline in the use of reverse termination fees, with only 58% of transactions utilizing a reverse termination fee compared to 82% in 2022, which is primarily due to the decrease in "specific performance lite" constructs used to address availability of debt financing at closing.
- Only one transaction in 2023 initiated by a significant or substantial shareholder was subject to a majority of the minority vote, potentially reflecting a reduced prevalence of such provisions amid increased shareholder vocalism in buyout situations and uncertainty of achieving stockholder approval thresholds.
- Overall, negotiation periods lengthened, with final prices often being reduced from the first offer price, reflecting extended diligence periods with management teams, and volatility in debt and equity markets.
 - In 2023, 14 (42%) transactions were negotiated for more than 200 days between the initial bid received by the target and the signing of the merger agreement, whereas in 2022 nearly half of transactions progressed from first offer to announcement in less than 100 days.
 - In 2023, 39% of transactions had a final deal price below the first offer price, compared to only 24% being revised downward prior to signing in 2022.



Going Private Transactions

Key Themes for Market Activity

Activity Remains Robust

- In 2023, corporate strategic buyers were less active, in part due to compressed valuation multiples and increased regulatory scrutiny, potentially resulting in less competition for sponsors.
- Technology and software industries continue to be actively targeted, particularly by buyout funds such as Vista Equity Partners and Thoma Bravo, which have competitive advantages in these sectors.
- As sellers and buyers reset valuation expectations, an improved M&A environment is expected in 2024 with prospects for lower interest rates and ample private equity dry powder.

De-SPACs and Recent IPOs a Focus

- There has been a recent uptick of going private transactions amongst underperforming companies that went public via a traditional IPO or de-SPAC transaction from 2020 through 2022.
- De-SPAC companies, in particular, often have longer-tail business models reliant on low-cost access to capital, and as the benefits of being public diminish, many de-SPACs are turning back to the private markets to better manage liquidity and expectations.
- Buyout valuations are often significantly lower than valuations at the time of public listing, and, in certain cases, significant stockholders are buying out the companies they previously took public.

Shareholder Activism as a Catalyst

- As highlighted by campaigns such as Engine No. 1's successful proxy contest against ExxonMobil in 2021, shareholders have the potential to be activists and achieve board representation or advance other demands regardless of the size of their holdings.
- De-SPAC companies saw an outsized number of short attacks and board nominations in 2021 and 2022, which has subsequently led to increased demands for M&A and return of capital.
- Activists are expected to be more aggressive with M&A demands as the M&A market improves.

Debt Financing Remains Available Albeit More Expensive

- Investor demand for private credit has ballooned the asset class to \$1.3 trillion in global AUM, providing an alternative to traditional broadly syndicated loan processes and driving more flexible terms for borrowers.
- With the cost of first lien buyout debt now in excess of 10%, given rate increases, sponsors are writing higher percentage equity checks aimed at lower valuations to achieve targeted returns.

Heightened Awareness of Recent Litigation Developments

- Recent Delaware litigation and ensuing decisions (e.g., *Mindbody*) highlight the importance of process with appropriate oversight.
- The *In re Match Group, Inc. Derivative Litigation* case has potential implications regarding Delaware's *MFW* Doctrine and corporate controllers, controlled companies, and financial and legal advisors involved in related-party transactions.

Source: Public filings.

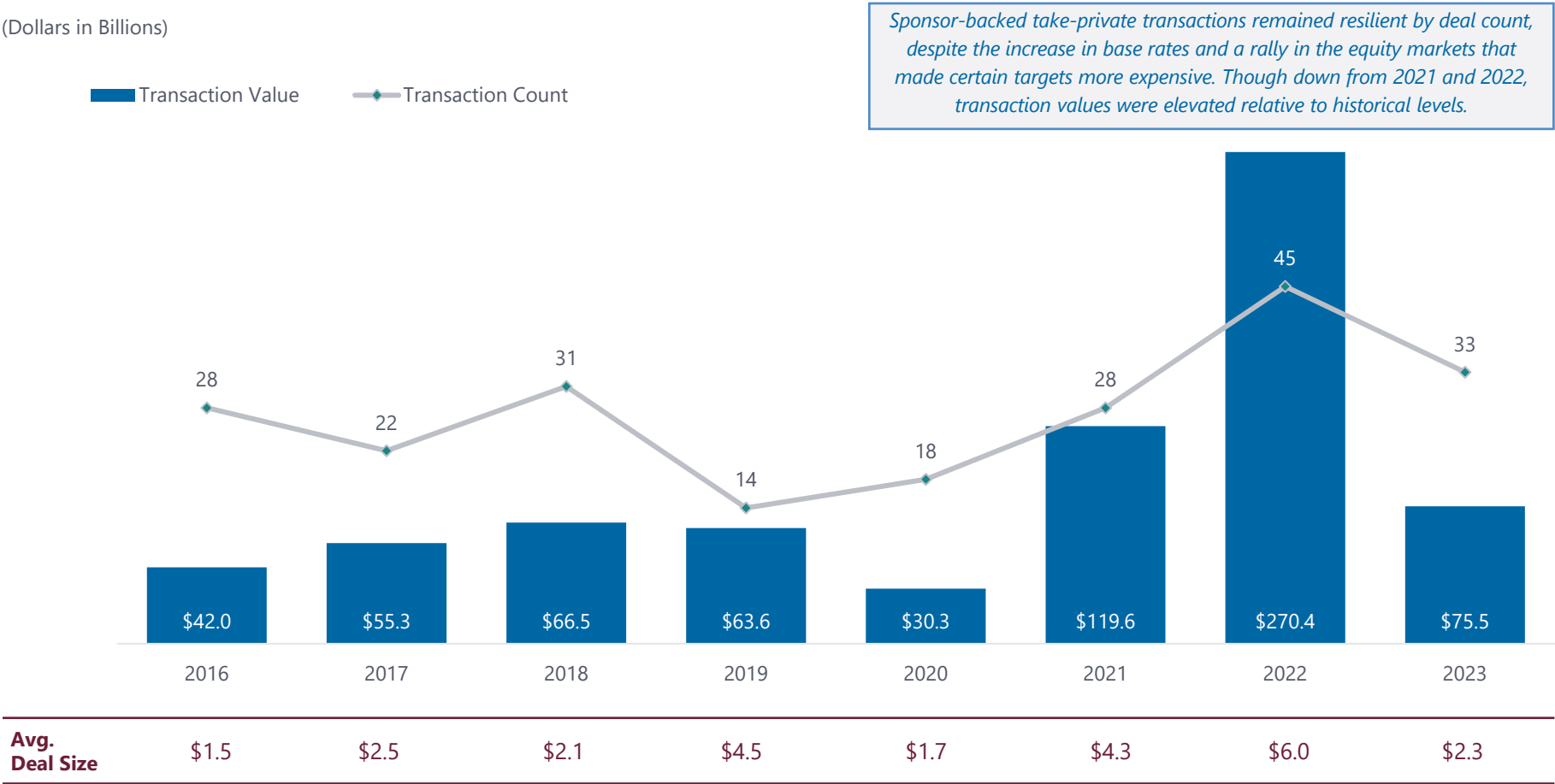


Sponsor-Backed Going Private Activity

Though down from the 2022 peak, sponsor-backed going private activity in 2023 was elevated by historical standards.

U.S. Sponsor-Backed Take-Private Transactions (2016–2023)⁽¹⁾

(Dollars in Billions)



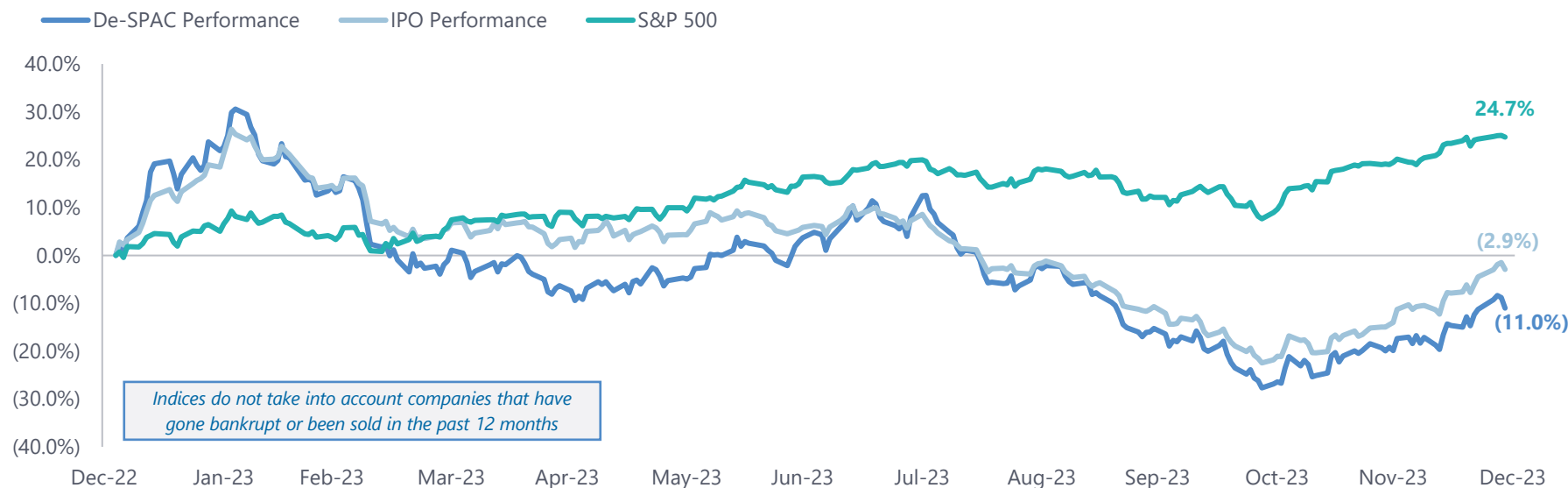
⁽¹⁾ Represents announced going private transactions involving targets with an implied enterprise value greater than \$50 million.
Source: LSEG (formerly Refinitiv).

Recently Listed Public Companies Underperforming Market

2023 Trading Performance: January 2020–December 2022 Traditional IPOs and De-SPACs

Companies making a public market debut between January 2020 and December 2022 have significantly underperformed the overall market in the past year, with companies listed via a traditional IPO faring comparatively better than those that underwent de-SPAC transactions.

One-Year Historical Trading Performance⁽¹⁾



De-SPAC Trading Performance Snapshot

~90%

Are trading below
\$10.00 per share

~35%

Are trading below
\$1.00 per share

40+

de-SPACs acquired

30+

de-SPACs filed for
bankruptcy

Note: Figures shown above calculated as of December 31, 2023.

Note: Indices derived based on equal-weighting methodology.

(1) The de-SPAC and recent IPO indices shown above include a fixed number of companies with (i) business combinations closed between January 2020 and December 2022 or (ii) IPOs completed between January 2020 and December 2022.

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and PrivateRaise.



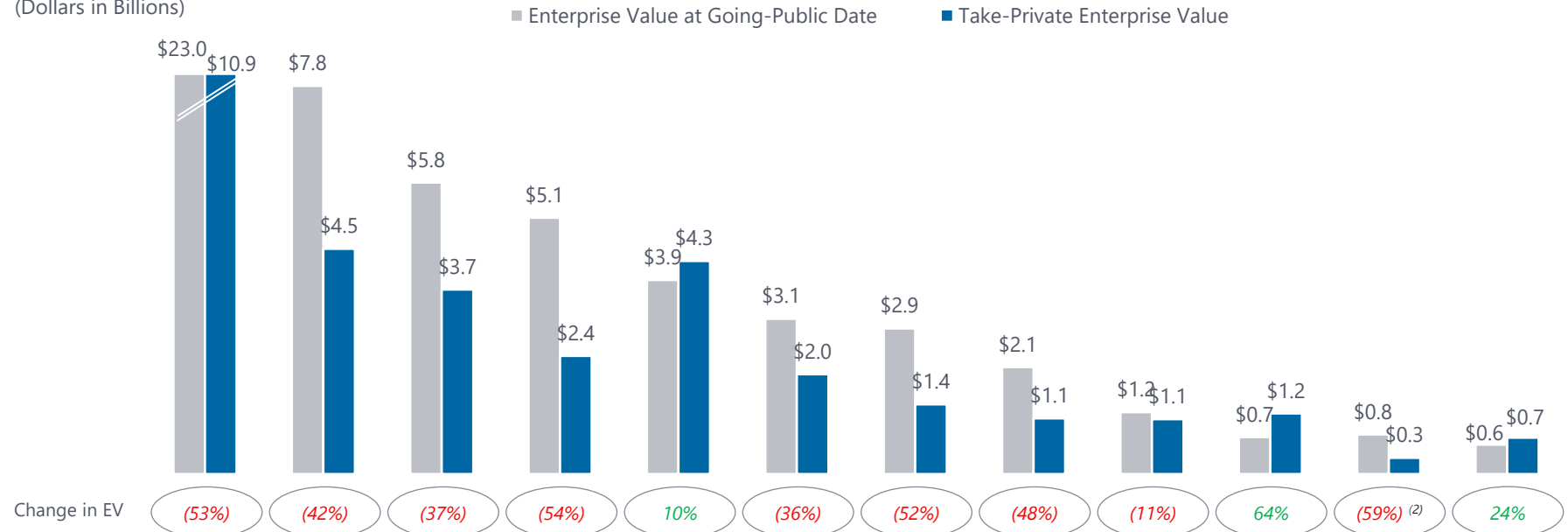
Sponsor Buyouts of Recently Listed Public Companies

2022–2023 Buyouts of Companies Recently Listed Via Traditional IPO

Buyout transactions have been completed shortly following an IPO, typically at a significant discount to the IPO price.

Sponsor-Backed Take-Privates Announced in 2022 and 2023 of Recent IPO Targets

(Dollars in Billions)



Target	qualtrics	Diversey	Weber	Duck Creek Technologies	KnowBe4	ForgeRock	sumo logic	UserTesting	convey	MAGNET	TREAN	Thorne HealthTech
Buyer	SILVERLAKE	SOLENIS	BDT CAPITAL PARTNERS, LLC	VISTA	VISTA	THOMABRAVO	FP FRANCISCO PARTNERS	THOMABRAVO	TPG	THOMABRAVO	ALTARIS	CATTERTON
Take-Private Announce Date	3/12/23	3/8/23	10/24/22	1/9/23	9/19/22	10/11/22	2/9/23	10/27/22	6/21/22	1/20/23	12/16/22	8/28/23
Years Public ⁽¹⁾	2.1	2.0	1.2	2.4	1.4	1.1	2.4	0.9	1.0	1.7	2.4	1.9

Note: Enterprise value at IPO determined based on the closing price of the first day of trading.

(1) Represents the period between the closing of the IPO and the announce date of the take-private transaction.

(2) Based on equity value.

Sources: S&P Capital IQ, LSEG (formerly Refinitiv), and press releases.

Sponsor Buyouts of Recently Listed Public Companies (cont.)

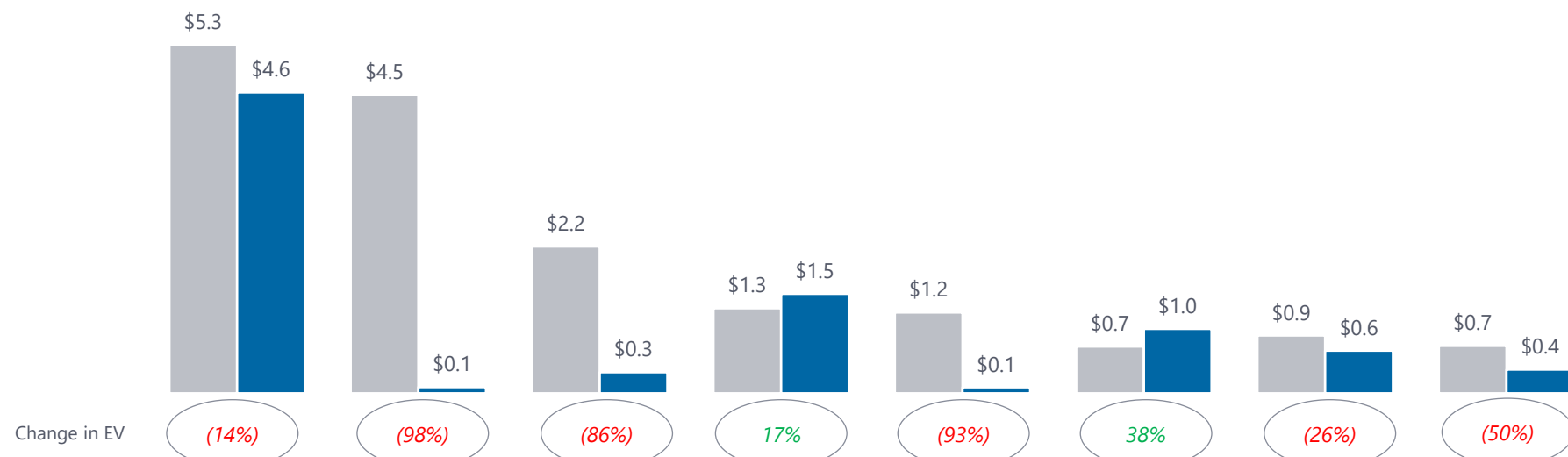
2022–2023 Buyouts of Companies Recently Listed Via De-SPAC

Most recent de-SPAC companies that are no longer publicly listed have engaged in transactions with sponsors or, in some cases, filed for bankruptcy.

Sponsor-Backed Take-Privates Announced in 2022 and 2023 of Post-De-SPAC Companies

(Dollars in Billions)

■ Enterprise Value at Going-Public Date ■ Take-Private Enterprise Value



Target								
Buyer								
Take-Private Announce Date	3/14/23	5/25/23	2/9/23	9/28/22	3/30/23	1/31/23	10/27/22	2/3/22
Years Public ⁽¹⁾	1.3	1.5	1.6	1.7	1.2	3.0	7.2	1.3

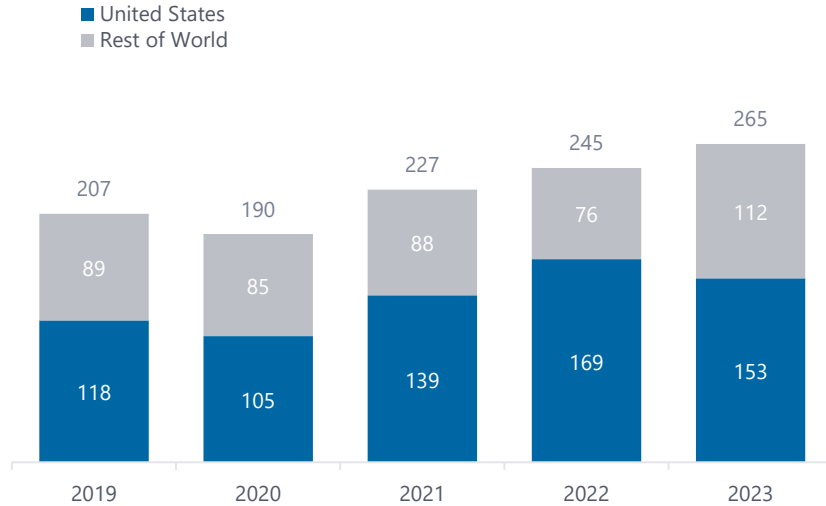
(1) Represents the period between the closing of the de-SPAC transaction and the announce date of the take-private transaction.

Sources: S&P Capital IQ, LSEG (formerly Refinitiv), and press releases.

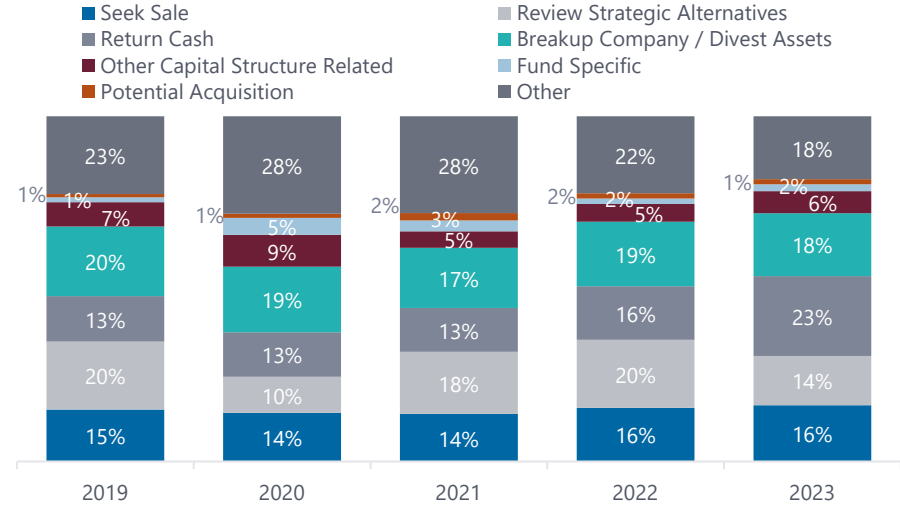
Shareholder Activism as a Catalyst for Going Private Transactions

Shareholders have become increasingly vocal over time with a particular focus on M&A and return of capital.

High-Impact Global Campaign Volumes



Overview of Campaign Value Demands



Recent Shareholder Activity With De-SPAC Companies

Date	Target	Shareholder	Situation
2/20/2024	 REPAY Realtime Electronic Payments	 PARTHENON CAPITAL	Parthenon disclosed a strategic review of its stake, leading to retention of an advisor to explore a sale
1/3/2024	 WHOLE EARTH BRANDS	 Notch View Capital	Following WEB's receipt of an offer in mid-2023, Notch urged an immediate sale to offer shareholders a premium exit, and later, WEB entered into an all-cash transaction for \$4.875/share
10/16/2023	 E2OPEN Demand. Supply. Delivered.™	 ELLIOTT	Elliott sought strategic opportunities to maximize shareholder value, including transactions in which Elliott may participate as an acquirer
10/12/2023	 TERRAN ORBITAL	Sophis Investments, Roark's Drift, Tyvak co-founders	Shareholder group urged for governance changes and strategic review leading to retention of an advisor and special committee formation
10/4/2023	 talkspace	 HARBOR SPRING CAPITAL	Harbor was in contact regarding alternatives to enhance shareholder value, including retention of an advisor to explore strategic alternatives

Note: "High-Impact" campaigns include the following objectives: Board Control, Board Representation, Maximize Shareholder Value, Remove Director(s), Remove Officer(s); excludes public short seller and bear raid campaigns and campaigns against companies with an equity market capitalization of under \$500 million at the time of announcement.

Sources: FactSet and public filings.

Debt Financing Markets

As direct lenders competed for market share, debt was available to fund going private transactions in 2023 on favorable terms; however, higher interest rates played a role in the broader slowdown in M&A activity.

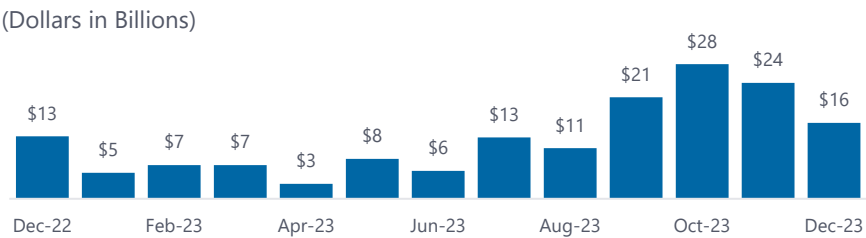
The Rise of Direct Lending

- The rise of direct lending began after heightened regulations were brought on by the GFC, leaving a funding gap that was filled by direct lenders.
- In recent years, the direct lending market has exhibited stability and continues to offer competitive terms relative to the public markets, particularly with sponsors seeking certainty.
- Some of the key features and distinctions of direct lending include:
 - PIK flexibility
 - Potential for portability
 - Greater flexibility on structure and process (e.g., ratings, timing certainty, smaller number of lenders)

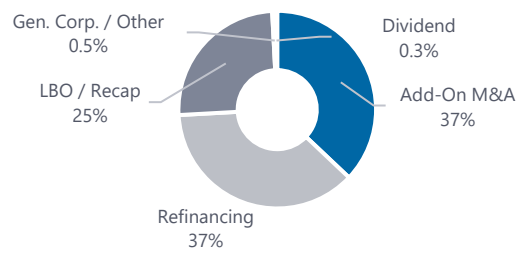
Interest Rates

- Increases in borrowing rates that began in early 2022 had peaked in late 2023 and are expected to decline to ~3.60%.
- Ability to service interest expense drove more conservative underwriting standards; the rise in benchmark interest rates resulted in a 500+ basis point increase when compared to 2021.
 - First-lien debt now often yields in excess of 10% per annum.
- If the Federal Reserve lowers interest rates, lenders may be comfortable with higher leverage, which could unlock a wave of deal activity.

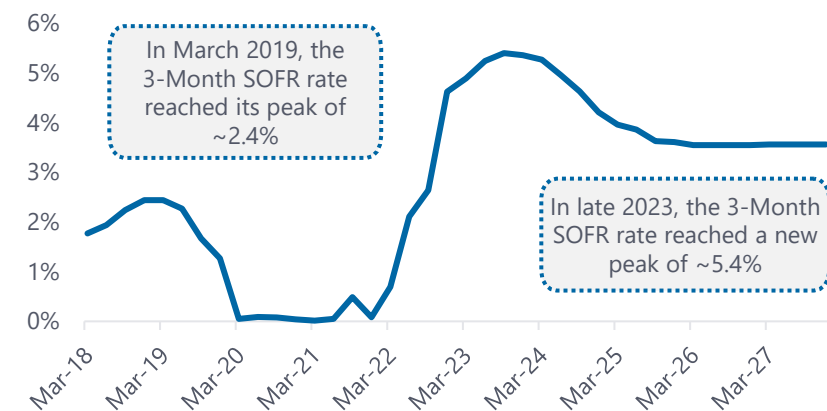
Direct Lending Volume



Use of Proceeds⁽¹⁾



Historical and Forward Borrowing Rates (3-Month SOFR)



⁽¹⁾ December 2023 volume by proceeds.
Sources: Bloomberg, DLD Weekly, KBRA DLD, LCD, and Pensford.

03 STUDY RESULTS

Summary Financial Statistics

- In the following table, we summarize the low, high, median, and mean financial metrics of the 33 transactions analyzed in the Study.

Summary Metrics

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$90.6	0.4x	3.8x	7.1x	0.4%	1.8%	0.8%
High	\$10,910.9	9.9x	233.9x	151.7x	123.9%	206.1%	137.9%
Median	\$1,663.1	2.6x	12.8x	20.4x	46.3%	39.2%	50.1%
Mean	\$2,595.3	3.5x	36.1x	30.0x	43.3%	47.7%	52.0%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.



Transaction Analysis by Target Company Size

- Four (12%) of the transactions in the Study had a transaction value in excess of \$5.0 billion, with one (3%) transaction in excess of \$10.0 billion.
- Transaction values in 2023, on average, are materially lower than transaction values in recent previous years.
 - For the calendar year ended December 31, 2022, there were a total of 45 going private transactions with a median and average TV of \$2,796.3 million and \$6,007.9 million, respectively, versus \$1,663.1 million and \$2,595.3 million, respectively, for the calendar year ended December 31, 2023.⁽¹⁾

Analysis by Target Company Size

(Dollars in Millions)

Transaction Value	Number of Transactions		TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽²⁾		
				TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
More Than \$10.0 Billion	1	Median	\$10,910.9	7.5x	NMF	NMF	59.8%	69.8%	87.5%
		Mean	\$10,910.9	7.5x	NMF	NMF	59.8%	69.8%	87.5%
\$5.0 Billion to \$10.0 Billion	3	Median	\$7,377.4	1.4x	8.5x	13.6x	25.0%	23.2%	44.0%
		Mean	\$7,362.4	3.0x	8.5x	13.6x	36.7%	35.0%	48.3%
\$1.0 Billion to \$5.0 Billion	20	Median	\$1,996.1	3.2x	12.1x	21.1x	33.7%	35.2%	48.2%
		Mean	\$2,451.2	3.7x	41.4x	32.7x	38.9%	38.9%	45.2%
Less Than \$1.0 Billion	9	Median	\$331.4	2.4x	26.5x	25.4x	53.1%	60.3%	54.9%
		Mean	\$402.6	2.8x	31.2x	30.1x	56.6%	71.7%	65.0%
All Transactions	33	Median	\$1,663.1	2.6x	12.8x	20.4x	46.3%	39.2%	50.1%
		Mean	\$2,595.3	3.5x	36.1x	30.0x	43.3%	47.7%	52.0%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) See "2022 Going Private Transaction Study Summary" in the Appendix for more detail.

(2) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.

Transaction Analysis by Date Announced

- Transaction volume peaked in Q1 2023, while the other quarters remained consistently active.
- Transaction values were meaningfully higher in the first quarter as compared to the rest of the year.
- Average implied multiples and acquisition premiums generally remained consistent throughout the year, with the highest acquisition premiums observed in Q2 2023.

Analysis by Transaction Announcement Date

(Dollars in Millions)

Transaction Date	Number of Transactions		TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
				TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
1/1/2023 - 3/31/2023	11	Median	\$2,368.9	4.6x	10.6x	13.0x	31.9%	29.0%	55.1%
		Mean	\$3,373.4	4.4x	65.2x	15.9x	46.9%	40.5%	58.5%
4/1/2023 - 6/30/2023	7	Median	\$1,663.1	1.4x	9.7x	17.8x	57.3%	76.7%	54.6%
		Mean	\$2,466.7	1.4x	24.1x	18.5x	56.9%	84.0%	59.6%
7/1/2023 - 9/30/2023	10	Median	\$1,360.1	2.7x	13.6x	20.4x	39.4%	32.6%	46.2%
		Mean	\$1,900.2	2.6x	15.1x	25.6x	34.9%	35.3%	42.6%
10/1/2023 - 12/31/2023	5	Median	\$2,151.8	2.5x	12.8x	20.4x	46.3%	43.0%	51.7%
		Mean	\$2,454.0	5.9x	69.0x	87.8x	34.9%	35.9%	48.4%
All Transactions	33	Median	\$1,663.1	2.6x	12.8x	20.4x	46.3%	39.2%	50.1%
		Mean	\$2,595.3	3.4x	36.1x	30.0x	43.3%	47.7%	52.0%

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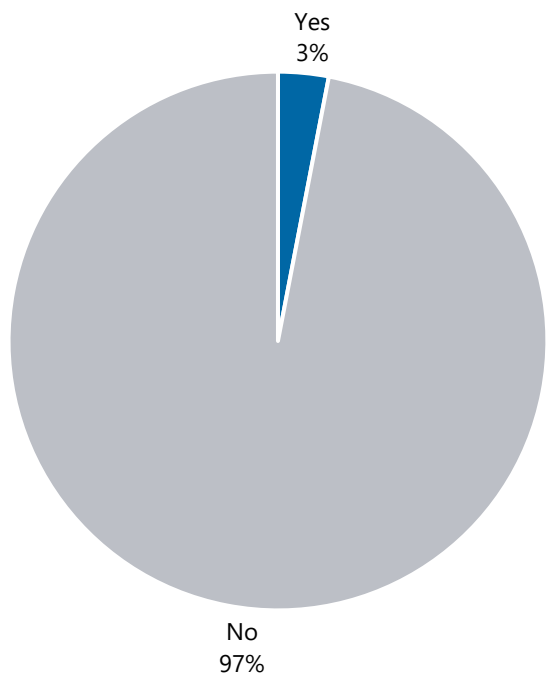
(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.

Management Initiation

- One transaction (3%) in the Study were initiated by the management of the target. For purposes of the Study, “management” does not include directors.

Was the Transaction Initiated by Management?



2022 Study:

Yes: 2%

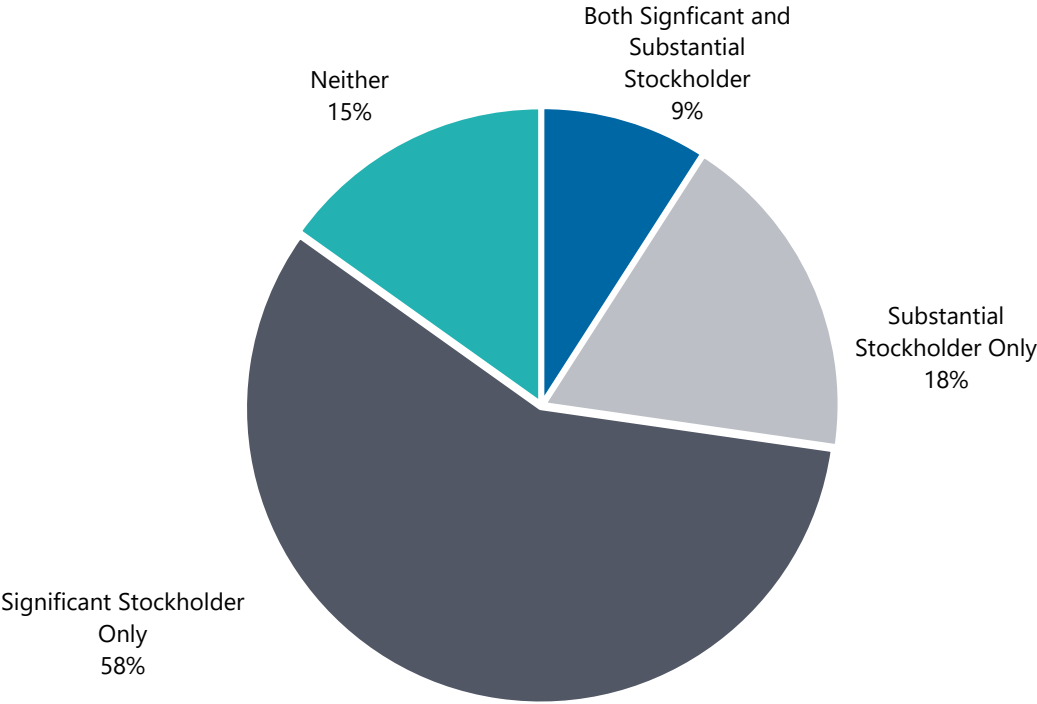
No: 98%

Source: Public filings.

Material Stockholders

- Twenty-eight (85%) target companies in the Study had at least one significant or substantial stockholder prior to the transaction, and three (9%) of the target companies had both a significant and substantial stockholder prior to the transaction.

Was There a Substantial (≥ 35%) or Significant (> 10% and < 35%) Stockholder Prior to the Transaction?



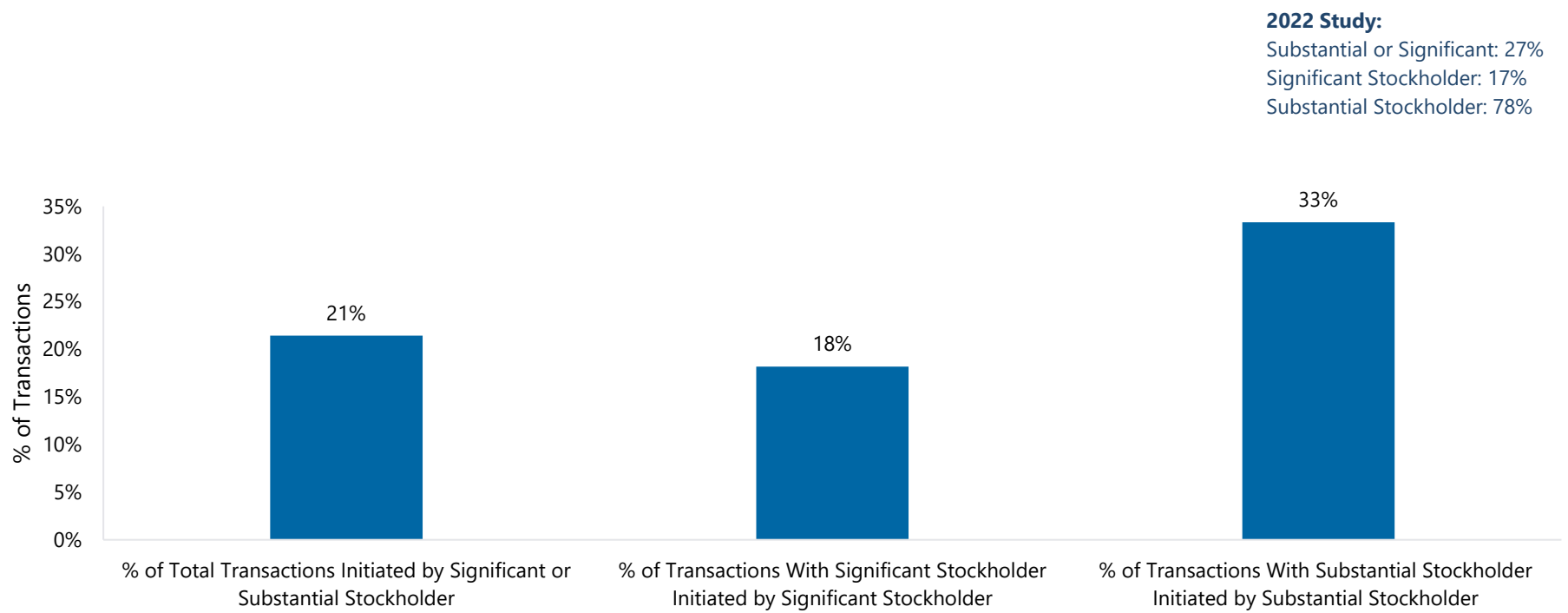
2022 Study:
Substantial Stockholder Only: 9%
Significant Stockholder Only: 53%
Neither: 27%
Both: 11%

Source: Public filings.

Material Stockholder Initiation

- Of the 28 transactions in which the target company had a significant or substantial shareholder, six (21%) were initiated by the significant or substantial stockholder, with one of those transactions being initiated by both a significant and substantial shareholder.
- Significant stockholders were less likely to initiate a transaction, doing so in four (18%) of the 22 cases in which there was a significant stockholder.
- Of the nine transactions in which the target company had a substantial stockholder prior to the transaction, three (33%) transactions were initiated by that substantial stockholder.

Did a Significant or Substantial Stockholder Initiate the Transaction Process?

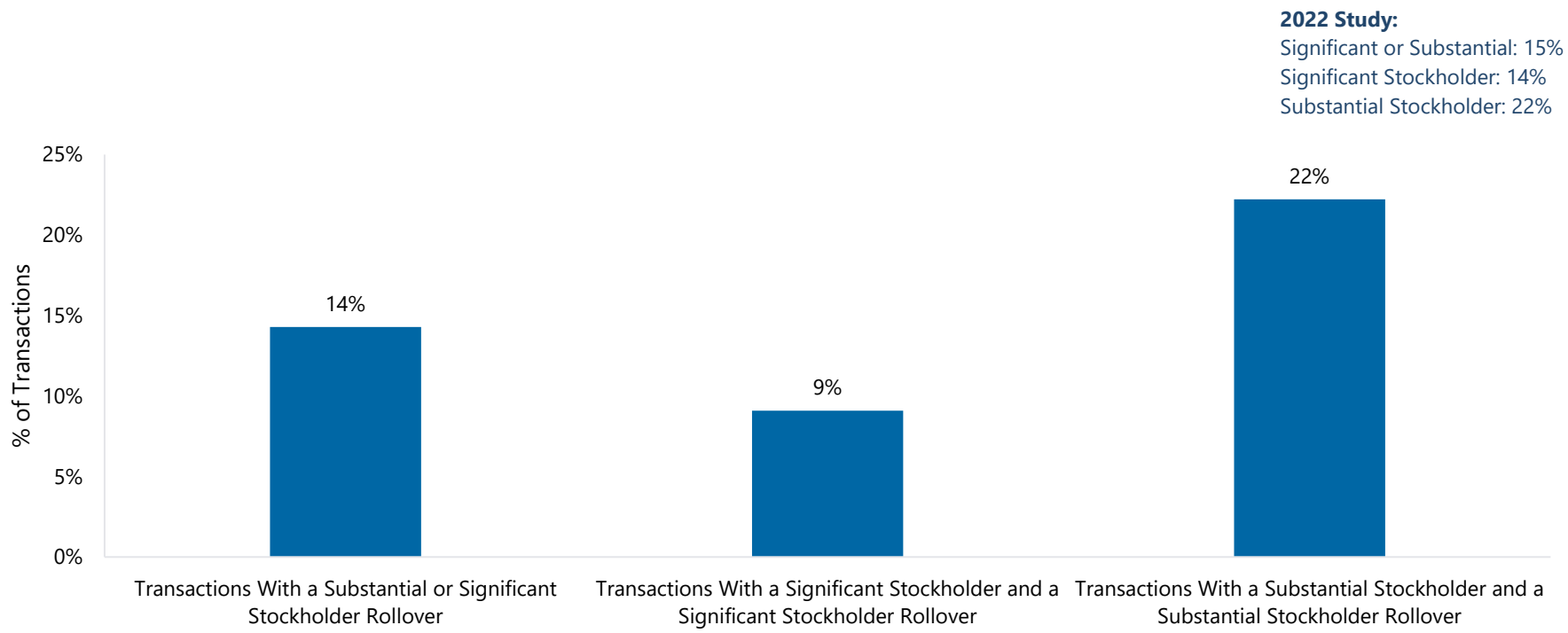


Source: Public filings.

Material Stockholder Rollover

- In the Study, significant and substantial stockholders rolled over their target stock into stock of the acquisition vehicle or the surviving corporation in four (14%) of the 28 applicable transactions.
- Two (9%) of the 22 transactions with a significant shareholder rolled over their holdings into the acquisition vehicle or surviving corporation.
- Where a substantial stockholder existed prior to the transaction, at least a portion of that stockholder’s position was rolled over in two (22%) of the nine applicable transactions.

Major Stockholder Rollover

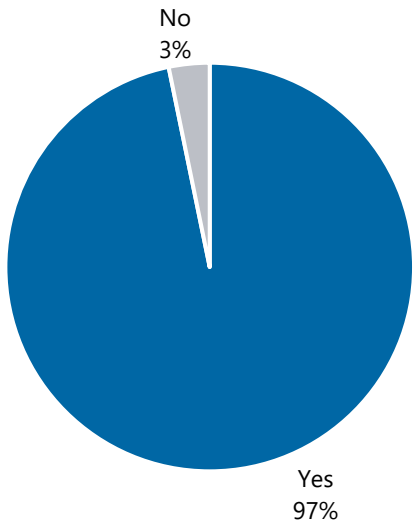


Source: Public filings.

"Auctioned" Targets

- Prior to certain going private transactions, the target company retained a financial advisor to contact potential buyers and solicit proposals to acquire the target company (an "auction").
- 32 (97%) of the targets in the Study undertook a process to auction the company prior to the execution of a transaction agreement.
- Four (100%) of the targets involved in transactions with TVs above \$5.0 billion were auctioned, as compared to 28 (97%) of the targets with TVs of less than \$5.0 billion.

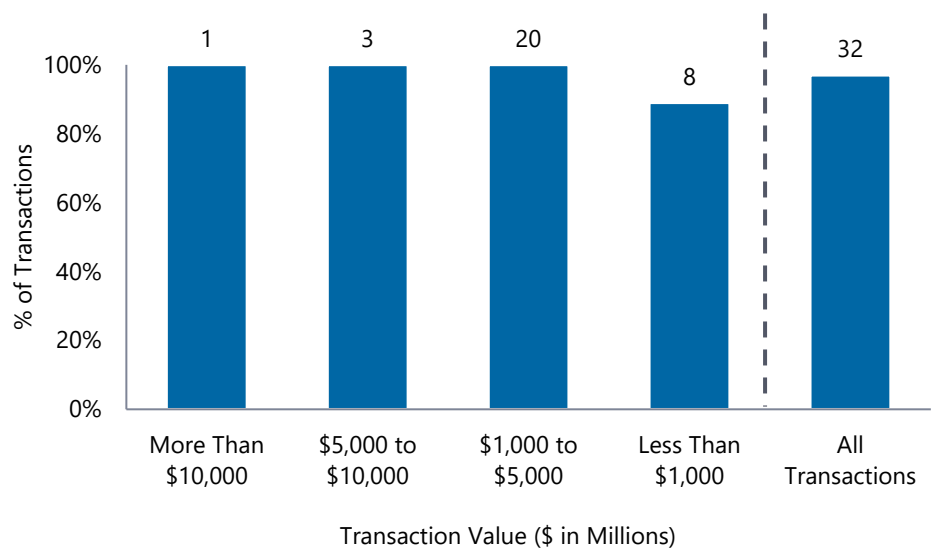
Was the Company "Auctioned?"



2022 Study:

Yes: 93%
No: 7%

% of Total Transactions "Auctioned"

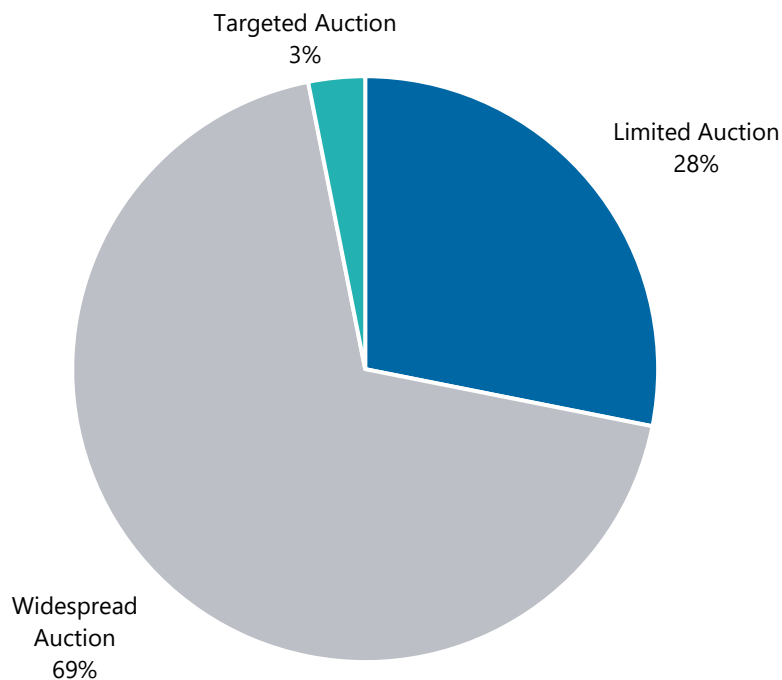


Source: Public filings.

Auction Process

- In 22 (69%) of the 32 transactions where the target was auctioned prior to the execution of a transaction agreement, the auction process was widespread (in excess of 15 prospective buyers solicited).
- Nine (28%) of the auctioned transactions involved limited auctions (five to 15 parties solicited).
- One (3%) of the auctioned transactions was involved in a targeted auction (less than five parties solicited).

If the Company Was Shopped Prior to an Acquisition Agreement Being Signed, Was the Process a Widespread, Limited, or Targeted Auction?



2022 Study:

Targeted: 31%

Limited: 31%

Widespread: 38%

Source: Public filings.

Auction Process (cont.)

- Average implied multiples and acquisition premiums were comparable for transactions with a widespread auction process (more than 15 parties) and with a limited auction process (five to 15 parties). Only one transaction featured a targeted auction process (less than five parties).

Widespread Auction Processes (22 Transactions)

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$90.6	0.5x	5.8x	9.4x	0.4%	9.6%	0.8%
High	\$10,910.9	9.7x	30.3x	40.7x	123.9%	206.1%	137.9%
Median	\$1,713.5	2.8x	12.1x	19.8x	46.3%	43.0%	54.0%
Mean	\$3,077.5	3.7x	15.1x	23.2x	45.6%	53.2%	53.5%

Limited Auction Processes (9 Transactions)

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$162.9	0.4x	5.5x	7.1x	2.5%	1.8%	14.2%
High	\$4,577.1	9.9x	26.5x	23.8x	74.1%	76.7%	85.8%
Median	\$1,585.4	2.6x	11.7x	20.4x	26.8%	28.4%	50.1%
Mean	\$1,705.0	3.7x	13.3x	17.1x	33.8%	32.5%	49.9%

Targeted Auction Processes (1 Transaction)

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$1,389.8	0.7x	3.8x	9.9x	64.9%	66.3%	46.7%
High	\$1,389.8	0.7x	3.8x	9.9x	64.9%	66.3%	46.7%
Median	\$1,389.8	0.7x	3.8x	9.9x	64.9%	66.3%	46.7%
Mean	\$1,389.8	0.7x	3.8x	9.9x	64.9%	66.3%	46.7%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

Public Disclosure

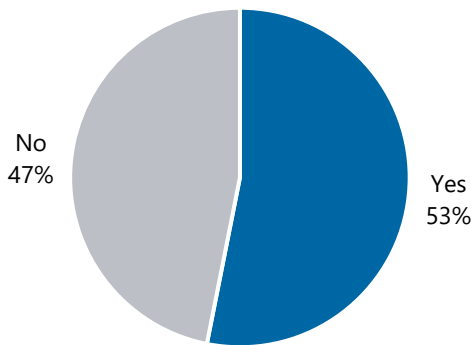
- In 47% of the 32 transactions where there was an auction, there was no contemporaneous public announcement of the auction process.
- Widespread auctions constituted (i) 12 (71%) of the 17 transactions in which an auction process was publicly disclosed and (ii) 10 (67%) of the 15 transactions in which the process was not publicly disclosed.
 - Auction processes with public disclosure included transactions with generally higher transaction values as compared to auction processes without public disclosure.

Transaction Value Analysis

(Dollars in Millions)

	Public Disclosure	No Public Disclosure
Low	\$162.9	\$90.6
High	\$10,910.9	\$3,790.5
Median	\$3,000.0	\$1,290.1
Mean	\$3,855.5	\$1,323.5

Was There Contemporaneous Public Disclosure of the Auction Process?

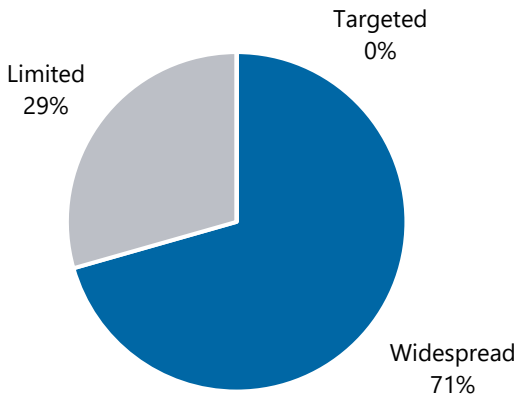


2022 Study:

Yes: 19%
No: 81%

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

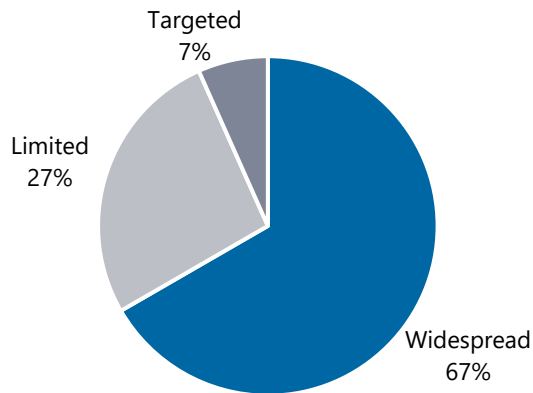
If There Was Public Disclosure, Was the Process a Widespread, Limited, or Targeted Auction?



2022 Study:

Targeted: 25%
Limited: 13%
Widespread: 63%

If There Was No Public Disclosure, Was the Process a Widespread, Limited, or Targeted Auction?



2022 Study:

Targeted: 32%
Limited: 35%
Widespread: 32%



Public Disclosure (cont.)

- Higher average and median implied multiples of EBITDA and EBIT were observed in transactions with an auction process that were publicly disclosed as compared to transactions with auctions that were not publicly disclosed.
 - The same is observed in the acquisition premiums.

Publicly Disclosed (17 Transactions)

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$162.9	0.4x	7.3x	9.4x	2.5%	1.8%	11.5%
High	\$10,910.9	9.7x	48.3x	37.5x	97.1%	91.9%	111.2%
Median	\$3,000.0	2.9x	10.7x	20.4x	48.2%	43.0%	48.2%
Mean	\$3,855.5	3.7x	15.0x	20.9x	44.8%	44.2%	49.2%

Not Publicly Disclosed (15 Transactions)

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$90.6	0.5x	3.8x	7.1x	0.4%	3.5%	0.8%
High	\$3,790.5	9.9x	27.3x	40.7x	123.9%	206.1%	137.9%
Median	\$1,290.1	2.6x	10.4x	13.5x	31.9%	25.3%	55.1%
Mean	\$1,323.5	3.5x	13.0x	20.9x	40.9%	51.6%	56.1%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

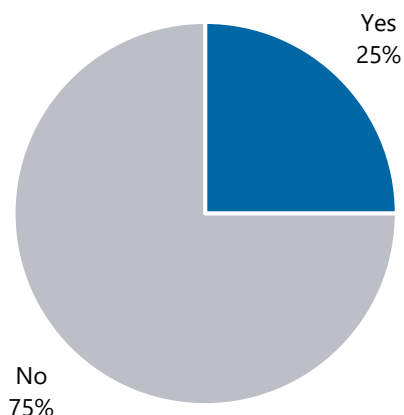
Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.



Exclusivity

- Exclusivity was granted to a prospective acquirer in eight (25%) of the 32 transactions in the Study where the Target was auctioned prior to the execution of a transaction agreement.
- Transactions with exclusivity periods garnered lower LTM multiples but higher acquisition premiums, on average, as compared to those without exclusivity periods.

Was Exclusivity Granted to Any Bidder During the Auction Process?



2022 Study:

Yes: 19%

No: 81%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

Transactions With Exclusivity Periods

(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$162.9	0.4x	3.8x	9.9x	6.8%	10.0%	11.5%
High	\$10,910.9	9.9x	30.3x	25.4x	123.9%	123.9%	137.9%
Median	\$1,355.8	1.7x	10.5x	13.5x	45.2%	47.3%	57.6%
Mean	\$2,580.7	3.5x	13.8x	16.3x	51.6%	50.3%	61.2%

Transactions Without Exclusivity Periods

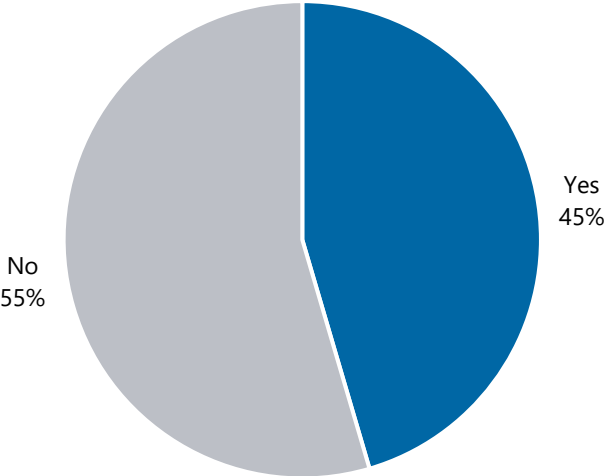
(Dollars in Millions)

	TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
		TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Low	\$90.6	0.5x	5.5x	7.1x	0.4%	1.8%	0.8%
High	\$8,112.5	9.7x	30.3x	40.7x	97.1%	206.1%	111.2%
Median	\$1,802.1	2.9x	11.7x	20.4x	40.9%	35.4%	51.7%
Mean	\$2,697.9	3.6x	13.9x	22.2x	40.0%	46.6%	48.9%

Special Committees

- In 45% of the transactions in the Study, a committee of independent directors was appointed to review and/or negotiate the transaction.
- Special committees were appointed in six (86%) of seven transactions that were initiated by a substantial or significant stockholder.

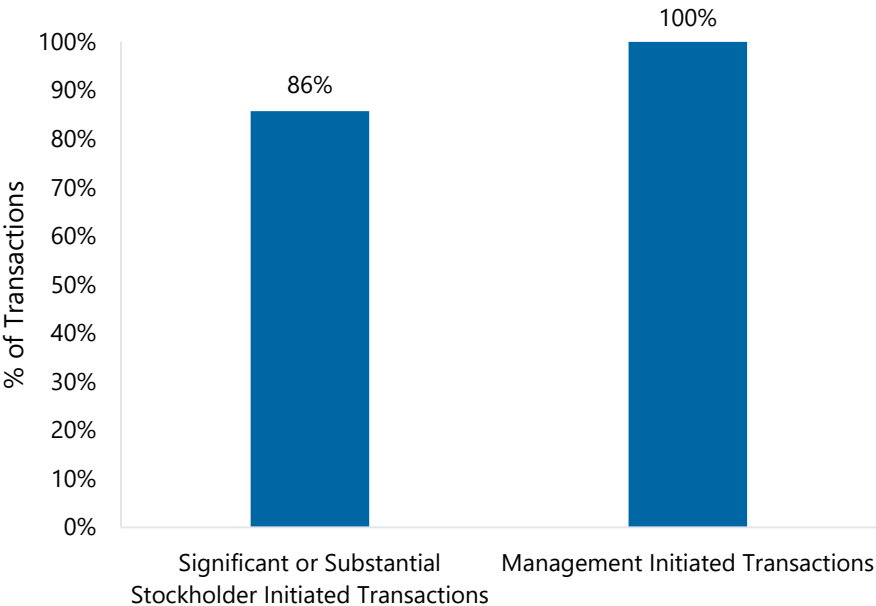
Was a Special Committee of Independent Directors Formed to Review the Transaction?



2022 Study:
Yes: 36%
No: 64%

Source: Public filings.

% of Transactions With Special Committees



2022 Study:
Significant or Substantial: 75%
All: 36%

Special Committees (cont.)

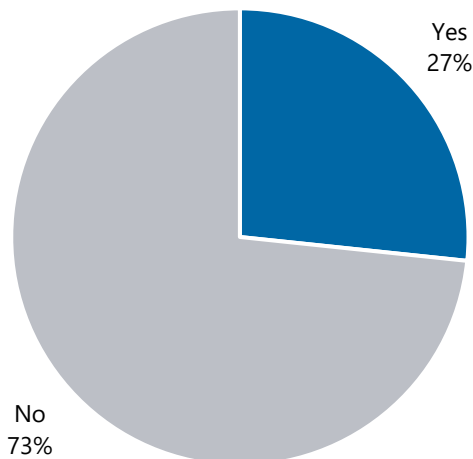
- In four (27%) of the 15 transactions where a special committee was formed, compensation paid to the committee members was disclosed.
 - In one instance, the chairperson was paid only a flat fee.
 - In all four instances, each committee member was paid on a per-meeting or per-month basis.

If There Was a Special Committee Formed, Was Compensation to Its Members Disclosed?

2022 Study:

Yes: 50%

No: 50%



Special Committee Monthly Compensation

Target	Special Committee Chairperson	Special Committee Member
Franchise Group, Inc.	\$100,000	\$90,000
EngageSmart, Inc.	\$140,000 (lump sum)	\$20,000
Fathom Digital Manufacturing Corporation	\$32,000	\$25,000

Special Committee Per Meeting Compensation

Target	Special Committee Chairperson	Special Committee Member
Cvent Holding Corp.	\$1,500	\$1,500

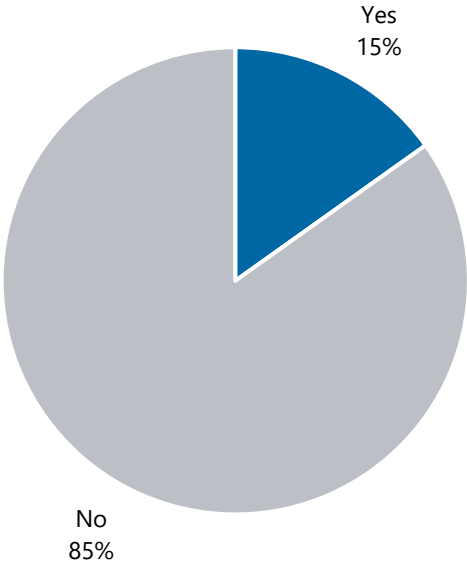
Source: Public filings.



Post-Transaction Employment

- Boards of directors of going private targets are reluctant to allow management to discuss post-transaction employment prior to the board’s selection of a winning bidder.

Did Management Discuss Post-Transaction Employment Prior to the Board’s Selection of a Winning Bid?



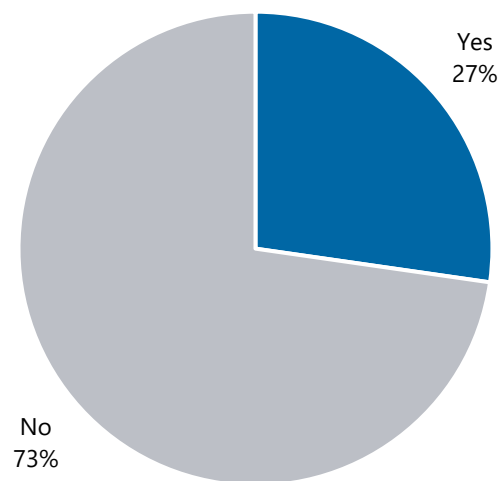
2022 Study:
Yes: 22%
No: 78%

Source: Public filings.

13E-3 Transactions

- Nine (27%) of the transactions in the Study were “13E-3 transactions” as defined under the Securities Exchange Act of 1934.⁽¹⁾

Was the Transaction a 13E-3 Transaction?



2022 Study:

Yes: 27%

No: 73%

(1) A going private transaction is subject to Rule 13E-3 if it involves (i) a purchase of any equity security by the issuer of such security or by an affiliate or (ii) a tender offer for any equity security made by the issuer or by an affiliate. An affiliate is viewed as a person who directly or indirectly controls, is controlled by, or is under common control with the issuer. Due to the potential for abuse and overreaching by the issuer and/or its affiliates, who may be viewed as having roles on both sides of the transactions, and the significant impact that such transactions can have on minority shareholders, Rule 13E-3 imposes certain filing, dissemination, heightened disclosure, and anti-fraud requirements on issuers and their affiliates engaged in these types of transactions.

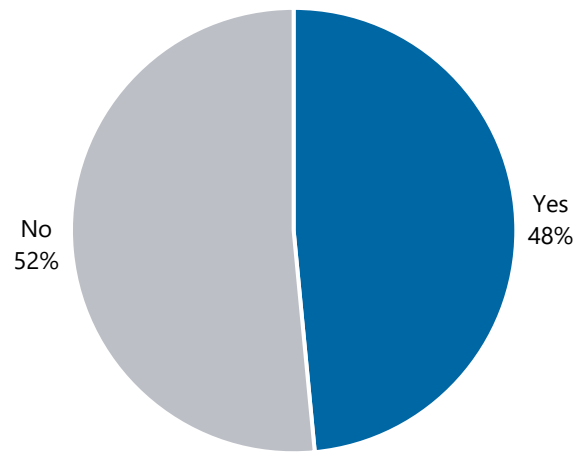
Source: Public filings.



Stockholder Lock-Ups

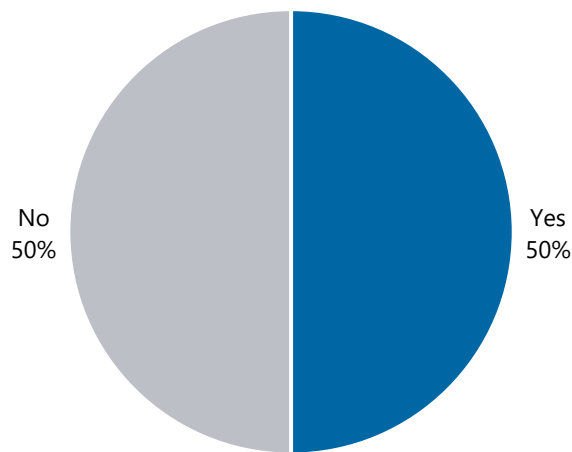
- Stockholder agreements to vote in favor of the transaction (a “lock-up”) were observed in 48% of the transactions in the Study.
- Of the 22 transactions involving a target with a significant stockholder, 11 (50%) had a lock-up.
- Seven (78%) of the nine transactions involving a target with a substantial stockholder had a lock-up of that stockholder.

Transactions With Stockholder Lock-Ups as a % of Total Transactions



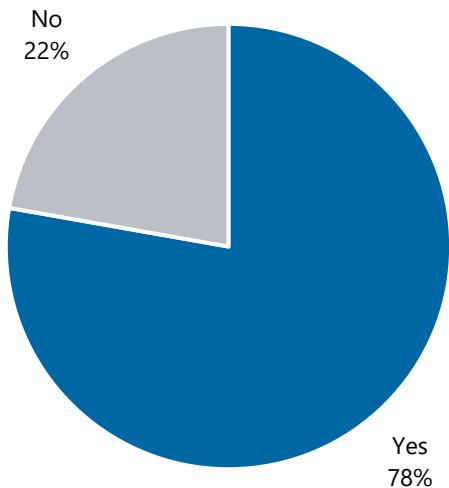
2022 Study:
Yes: 38%
No: 62%

Transactions With Significant Stockholder Lock-Ups as a % of Total Transactions With Significant Stockholders



2022 Study:
Yes: 38%
No: 62%

Transactions With Substantial Stockholder Lock-Ups as a % of Total Transactions With Substantial Stockholders



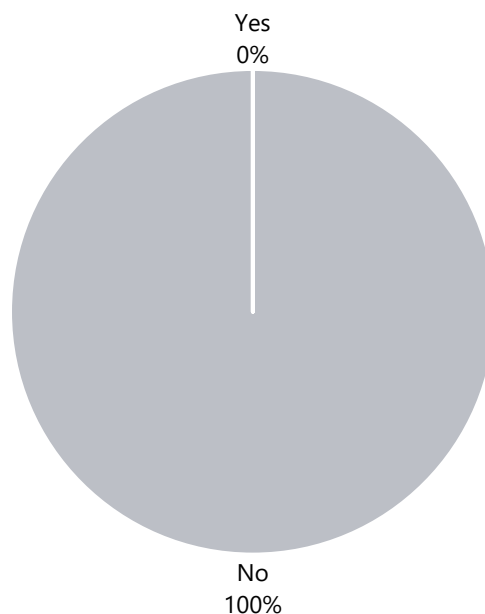
2022 Study:
Yes: 89%
No: 11%

Source: Public filings.

Approval by a Majority of the Minority

- In the Study, none of the seven transactions initiated by a substantial or significant stockholder or management were subject to approval by a majority of the minority stockholders.

Was the Transaction Subject to Approval by a Majority of the Minority if Initiated by a Substantial Stockholder, Significant Stockholder, or Management?



2022 Study:

Yes: 15%

No: 85%

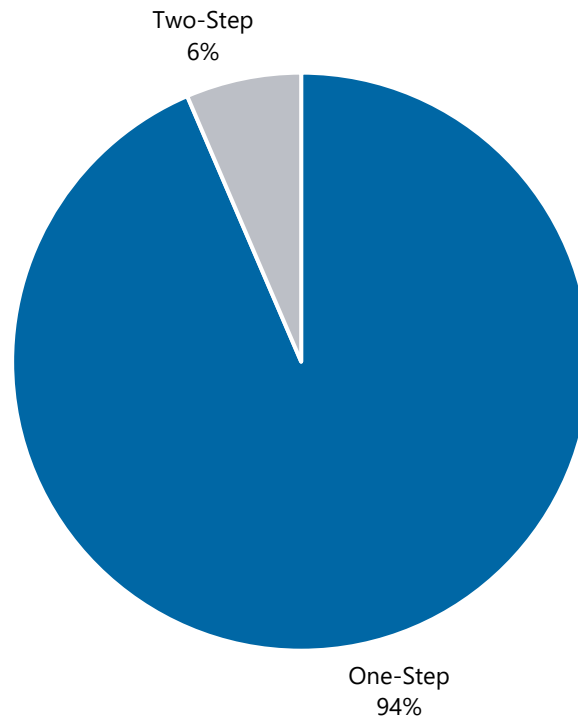
Source: Public filings.



Transaction Structure

- Despite the advantage of being able to quickly gain control of a target through the use of a tender offer, 94% of the transactions in the Study were structured as one-step merger transactions.

Transaction Structure



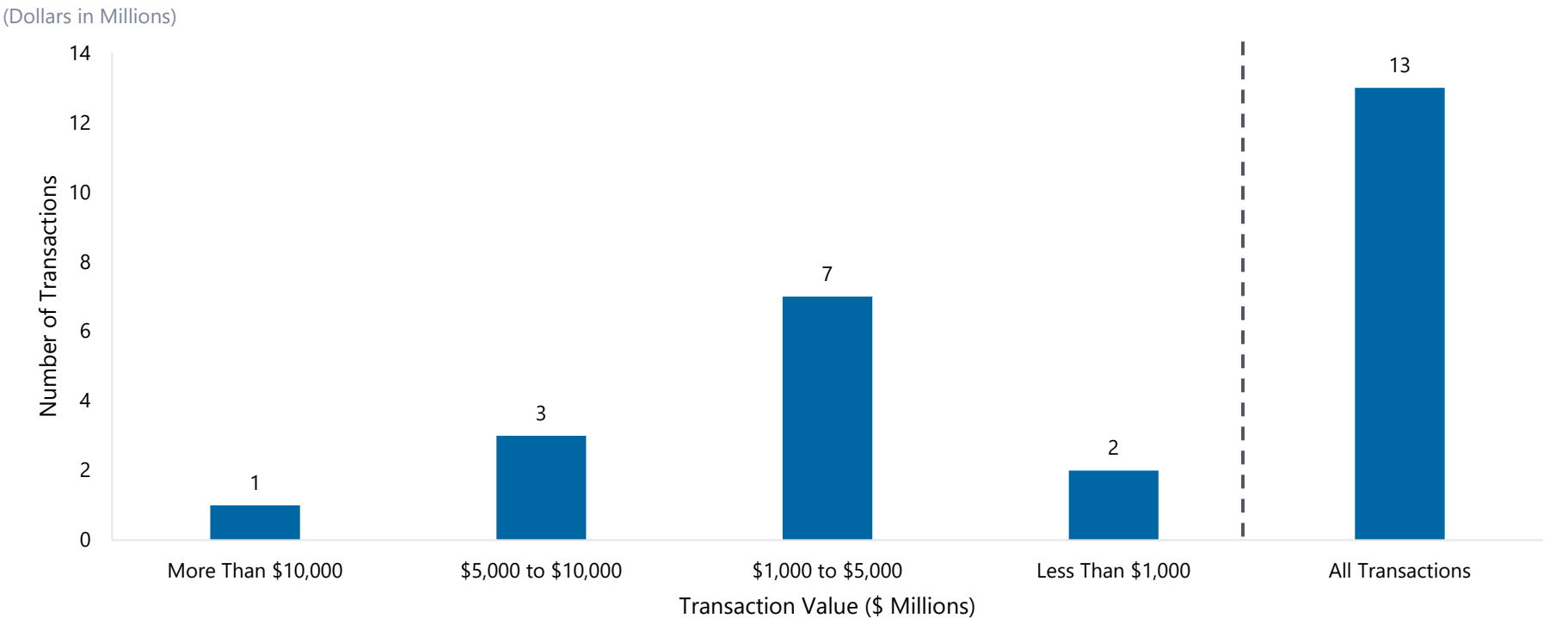
2022 Study:
Two-Step: 11%
One-Step: 89%

Source: Public filings.

Club Deals

- Thirteen (39%) of the transactions in the Study were “club deals” involving two or more sponsors.

Number of Club Deals by Transaction Value



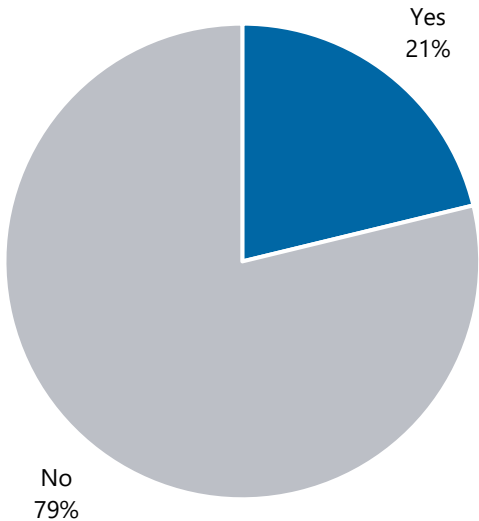
2022 Study:
Club Deals: 27%

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

Go-Shop Provisions

- Seven (21%) of the transactions in the Study provided for a post-agreement go-shop period.
- The average go-shop period length for all of the observed transactions was 35.0 days, with larger transactions having longer average “shopping days.”

Was There a Go-Shop Provision?

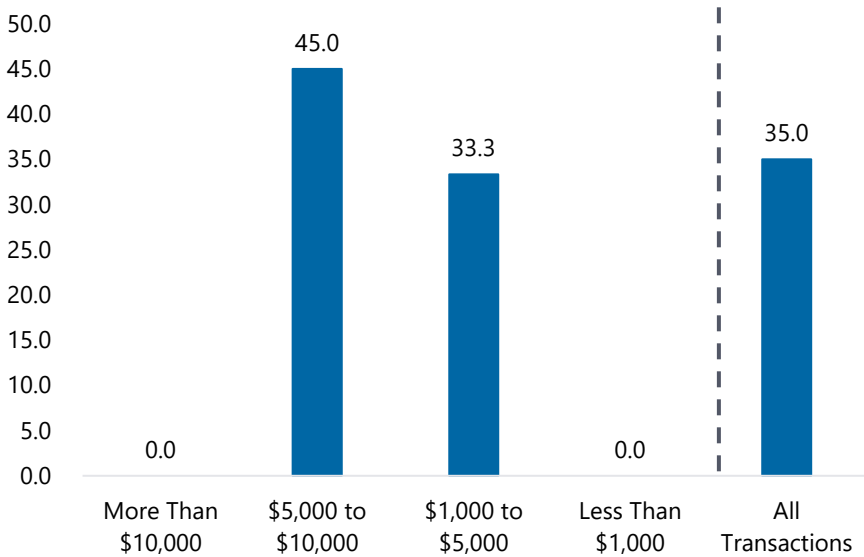


2022 Study:

Yes: 29%
No: 71%

Average Length of Go-Shop (Days)

(Dollars in Millions)



2022 Study:

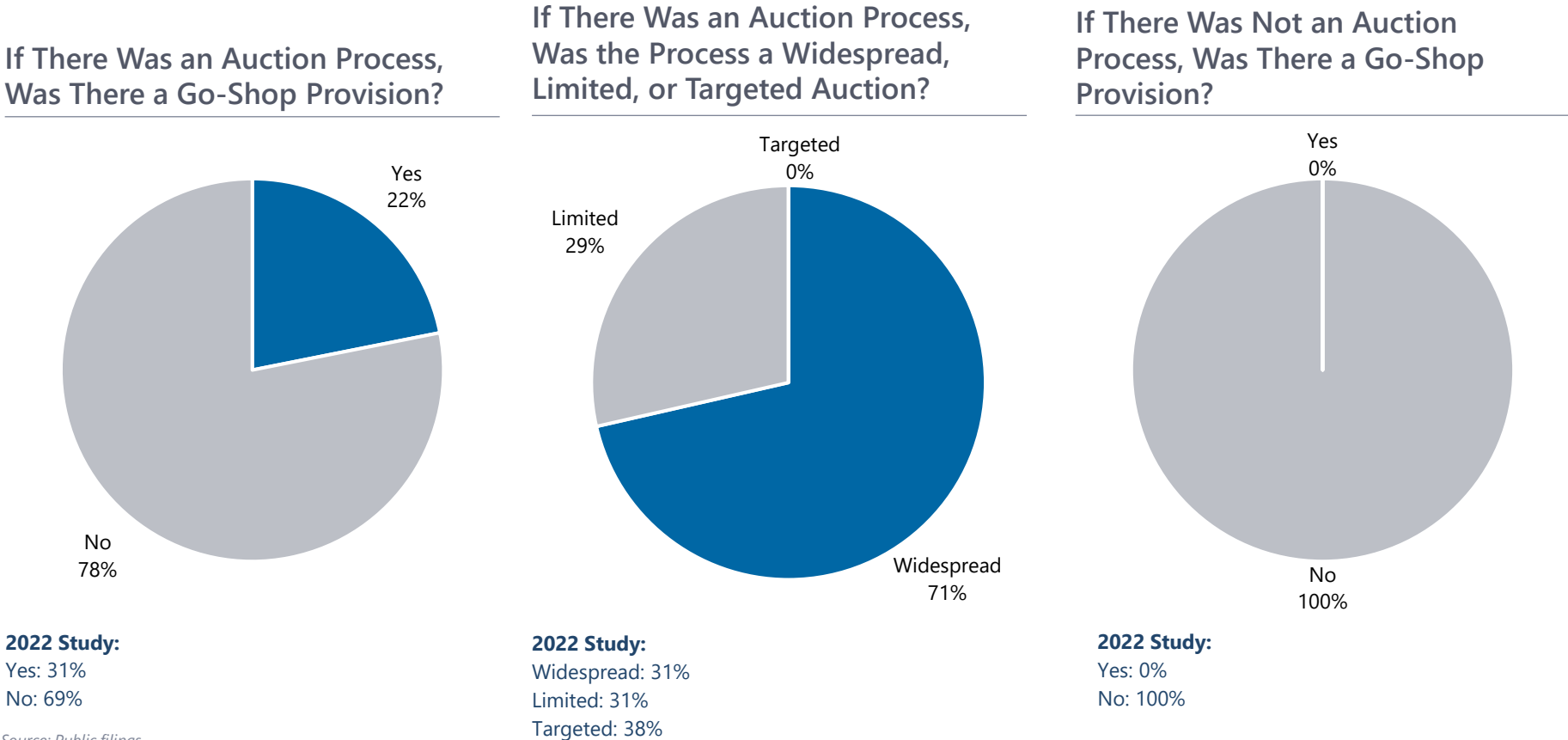
All Transactions: 37.8 days

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.



Go-Shop Provisions (cont.)

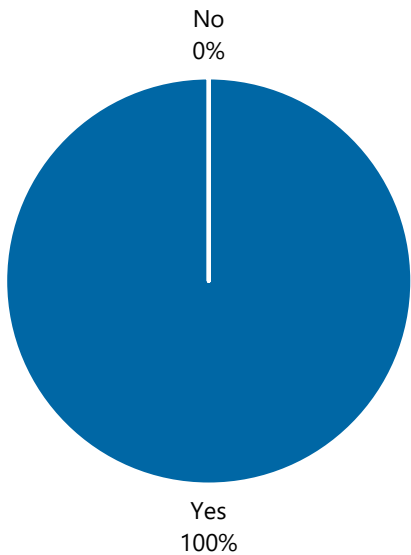
- In seven (22%) of the 32 transactions with auction processes, there was also a go-shop provision.
 - Of these seven, five (71%) were widespread auction processes and two (29%) were limited auction processes.
- Go-shop provisions were not present in the one transaction that was not preceded by an auction process.



Fiduciary Out to a Superior Proposal

- All transactions contained a fiduciary out in the event the target received a superior outside proposal (either pursuant to a go-shop provision or otherwise); however, in all cases, the original bidder was granted matching rights effective for a period of up to five days.

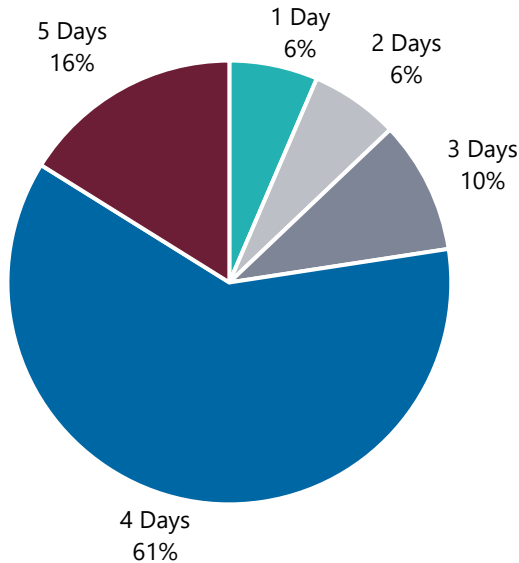
If There Was a Fiduciary Out for a Superior Proposal, Did the Original Bidder Have Matching Rights?



2022 Study:

Yes: 100%
No: 0%

If the Bidder Did Have Matching Rights, Over What Period Were the Matching Rights Effective?



2022 Study:

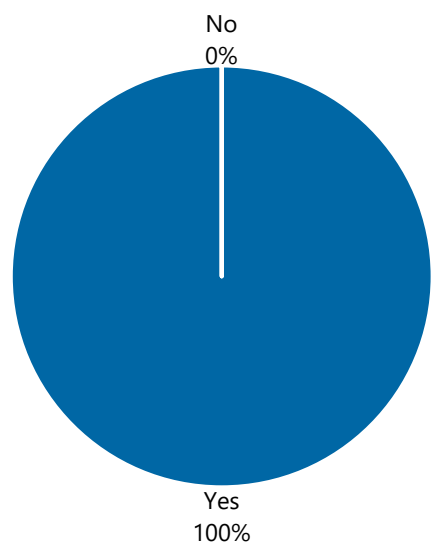
5 Days: 12%
4 Days: 59%
3 Days: 20%
2 Days: 2%
1 Day: 7%

Source: Public filings.

Fiduciary Out for an Intervening Event

- In all of the transactions in the Study, the target board was permitted to change its recommendation in favor of a deal by reason of an “intervening event.”
 - The definition of an intervening event varies by deal, but typical definitions may include that such event was not known by the target’s board and/or management as of the date of the merger agreement, is material, was not reasonably foreseeable, and/or occurs or arises after the date of the merger agreement.

Was There a Fiduciary Out for an “Intervening Event”?



2022 Study:

Yes: 100%

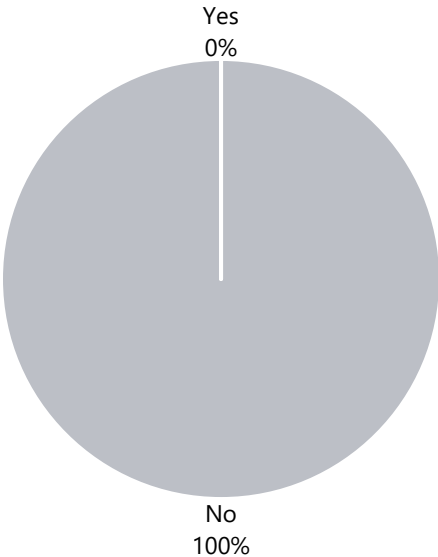
No: 0%

Source: Public filings.

Financing

- None of the transactions in the Study were conditioned on the availability of financing.

Was There a Financing Out in the Agreement?



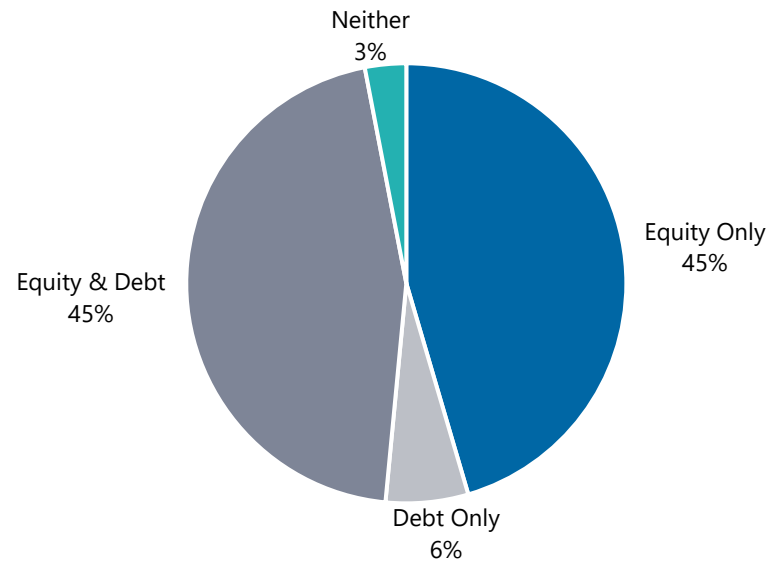
2022 Study:
Yes: 0%
No: 100%

Source: Public filings.

Financing (cont.)

- Commitment letters for the provision of debt and/or equity financing were delivered prior to signing the acquisition agreement in 97% of the transactions in the Study.

Was a Commitment Letter Delivered Upon Signing the Transaction Agreement?



2022 Study:

Equity & Debt: 73%

Equity Only: 18%

Debt Only: 4%

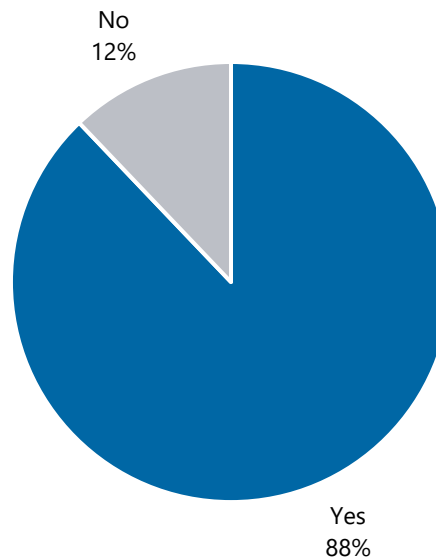
Neither: 4%

Source: Public filings.

Financing (cont.)

- In 88% of transactions, the financial sponsor (through the fund making the investment) guaranteed the payment of any reverse termination fees.

Did the Financial Sponsor Guarantee the Reverse Termination Fee?



2022 Study:

Yes: 78%

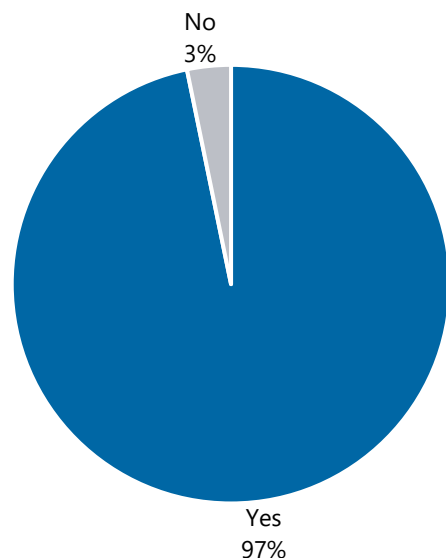
No: 22%

Source: Public filings.

Termination Fees

- 97% of the transactions in the Study featured a termination fee payable to the acquirer under certain circumstances in which the transaction did not close.
- Median and mean termination fees as a percentage of transaction value were approximately 2.9% and 3.1%, respectively, for all transactions.

Did the Transaction Have a Termination Fee?



2022 Study:

Yes: 96%

No: 4%

Termination Fee as a % of Transaction Value

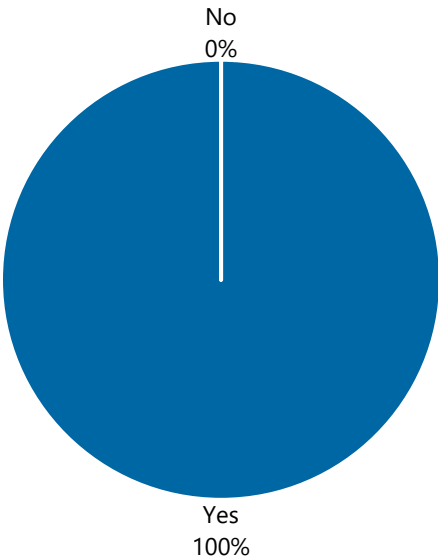
	<u>More Than \$10.0 Billion</u>	<u>\$5.0 Billion to \$10.0 Billion</u>	<u>\$1.0 Billion to \$5.0 Billion</u>	<u>Less Than \$1.0 Billion</u>	<u>All Transactions</u>
Low	2.4%	1.6%	1.5%	1.0%	1.0%
High	2.4%	2.9%	10.9%	4.1%	10.9%
Median	2.4%	2.2%	3.0%	2.8%	2.9%
Mean	2.4%	2.3%	3.4%	2.7%	3.1%

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

Bifurcated Termination Fees

- All of the transactions in the Study that had a “go-shop” provision had a bifurcated structure pursuant to which the termination fee during the go-shop period was lower than the termination fee payable after the go-shop period had ended.

For Transactions With Go-Shop Provisions, Was the Fee Bifurcated During the Go-Shop Period?



2022 Study:

Yes: 85%

No: 15%

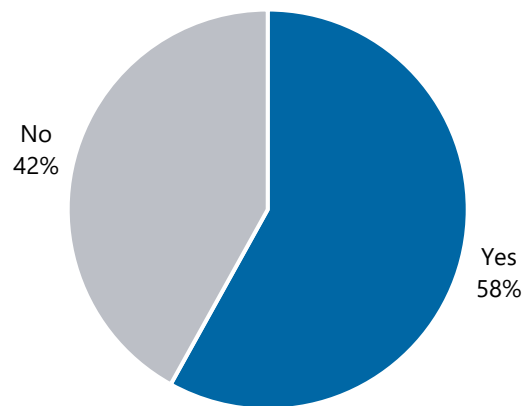
Source: Public filings.



Reverse Termination Fees

- 58% of the transactions in the Study had a reverse termination fee payable by the acquirer if the financing for the transaction fell through or the acquirer otherwise terminated the acquisition agreement.
- Median and mean reverse termination fees as a percentage of transaction value were approximately 5.3% and 6.0%, respectively, for all transactions.

Did the Transaction Have a Reverse Termination Fee?



2022 Study:

Yes: 82%
No: 18%

Reverse Termination Fee as a % of Transaction Value

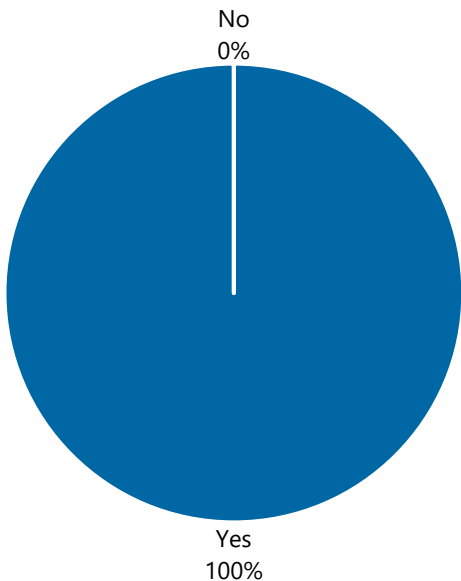
	More Than \$10.0 Billion	\$5.0 Billion to \$10.0 Billion	\$1.0 Billion to \$5.0 Billion	Less Than \$1.0 Billion	All Transactions
Low	NA	3.9%	3.3%	1.4%	1.4%
High	NA	7.9%	23.6%	7.5%	23.6%
Median	NA	4.1%	5.4%	4.3%	5.3%
Mean	NA	5.3%	6.6%	4.4%	6.0%

Sources: S&P Capital IQ and public filings.

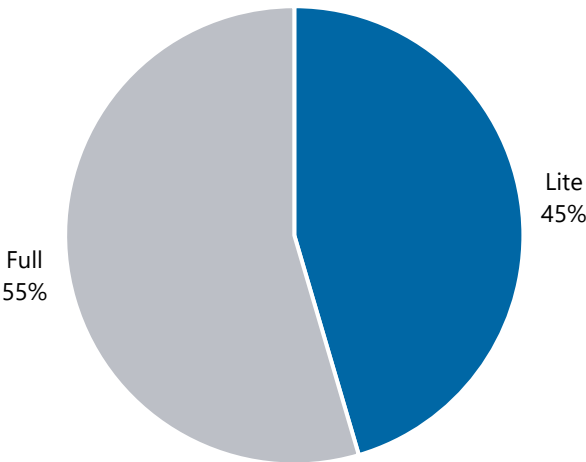
Specific Performance

- All of the transactions in the Study provided for specific performance. Of these, 15 (45%) provided for specific performance only if the acquirer’s debt financing was available (“specific performance lite”).

Was the Transaction Subject to Specific Performance?



Was the Transaction Subject to Specific Performance Lite or Full Specific Performance?

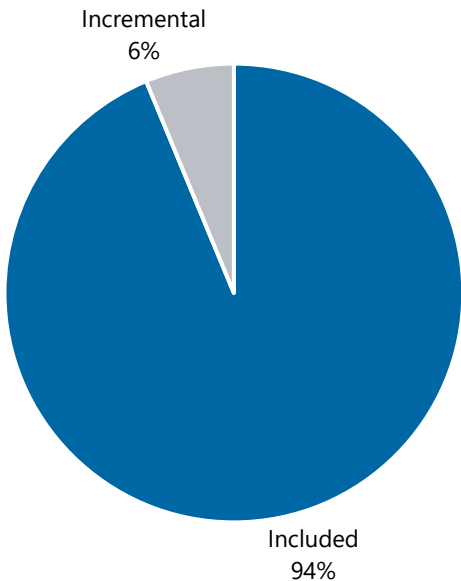


Source: Public filings.

Expense Reimbursement in the Event of Termination

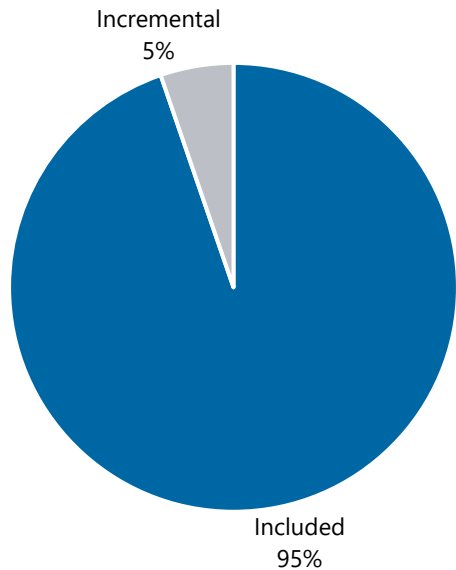
- Thirty-two of the termination fee provisions observed in the Study addressed treatment of expenses. Of these, two (6%) transactions provided for the reimbursement of transaction expenses (i.e., expense reimbursement was incremental to the termination fee payable upon termination). Additionally, expense reimbursement was treated as an incremental expense in one (5%) of the 19 reverse termination fee provisions that specified expense treatment.

Were Expenses Included in the Termination Fee or Incremental?



2022 Study:
Incremental: 26%
Included: 74%

Were Expenses Included in the Reverse Termination Fee or Incremental?



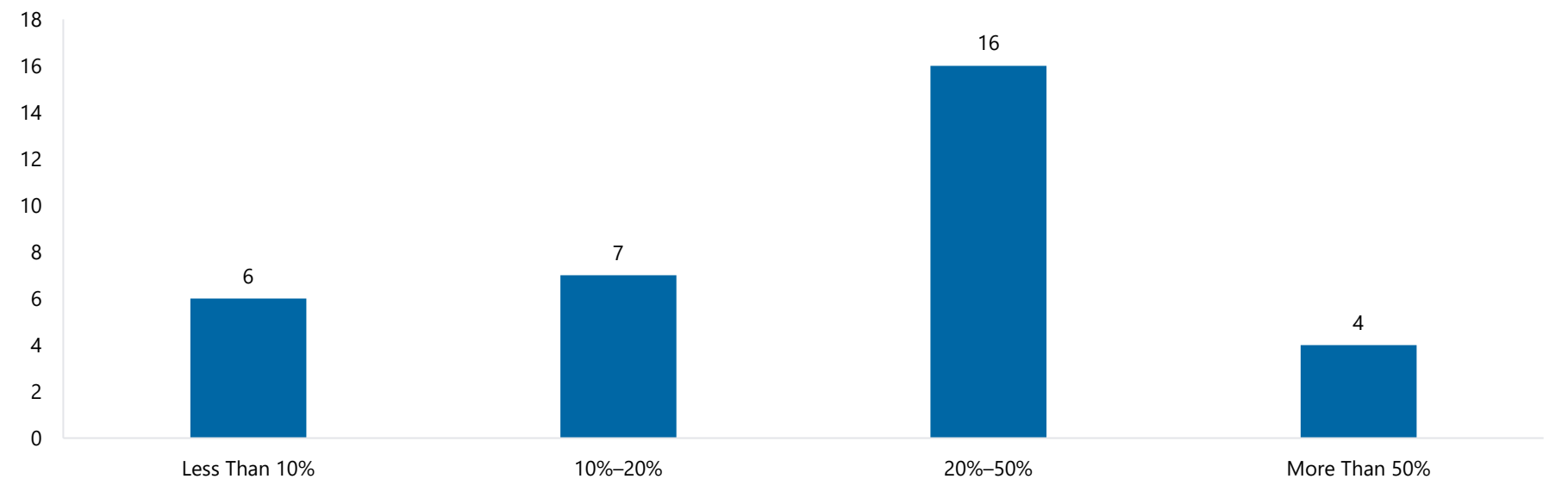
2022 Study:
Incremental: 17%
Included: 83%

Source: Public filings.

Initial Offer per Share Price Premium

- In 16 (49%) of the transactions in the Study, the first per share offer by any bidder was 20% to 50% higher than the target’s current stock price as of that date.

What Was the % Premium of the First Offer to Market Price of the Target’s Stock?



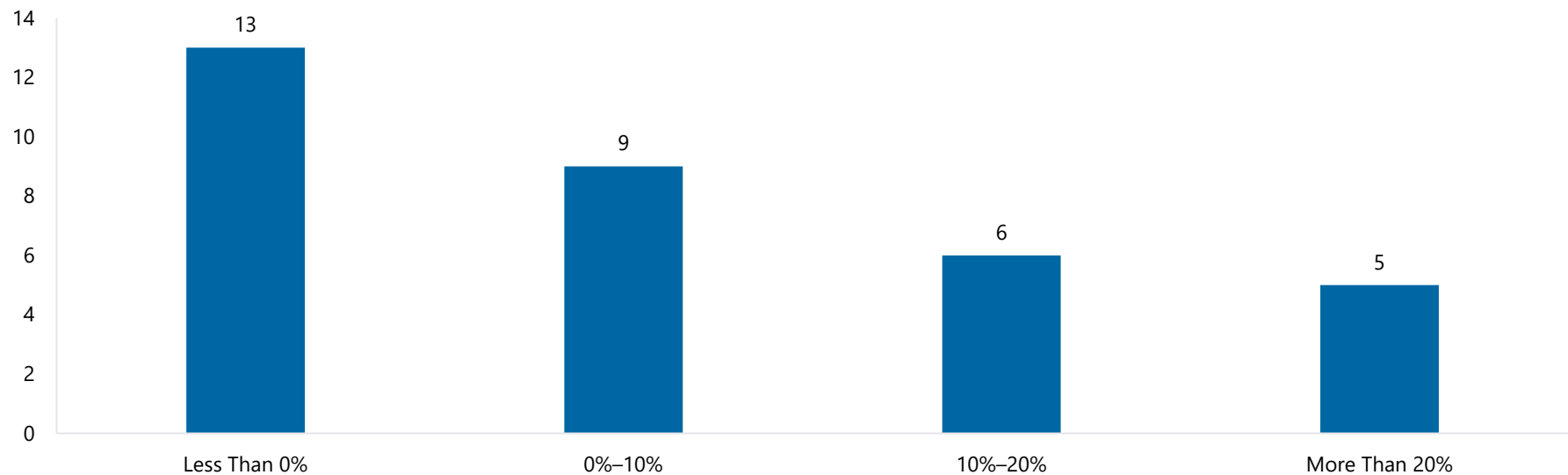
2022 Study:
0%–10%: 3
10%–20%: 10
20%–50%: 25
More Than 50%: 7

Source: Public filings.

Final Transaction Value per Share Premium

- In nine (27%) of the transactions in the Study, the final deal price was 0% to 10% higher than the initial per share offer by any bidder, and, notably, 13 (39%) of the transactions had a final deal price below the first offer price.

What Was the % Premium of the Final Deal Price to the First Offer Price?



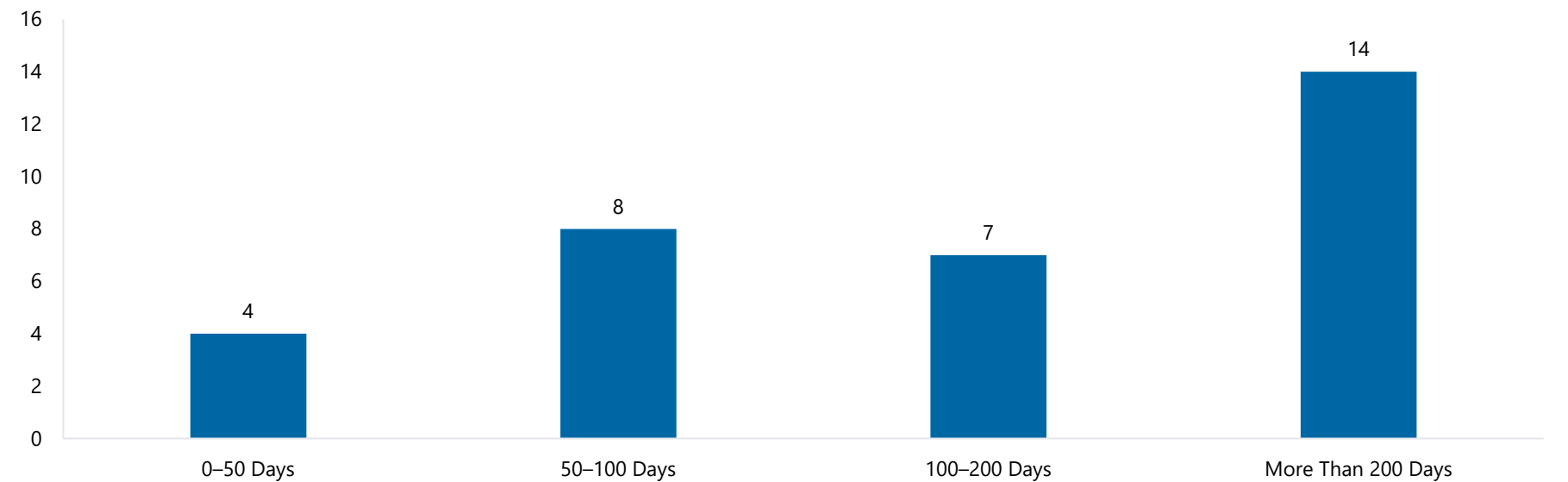
2022 Study:
Less Than 0%: 11
0%–10%: 21
10%–20%: 10
More Than 20%: 3

Source: Public filings.

Duration of Negotiation Process

- In 14 (42%) of the transactions in the Study, more than 200 days passed between the initial bid received by the target and the signing of the merger agreement.

What Was the Number of Days Between the Initial Bid and Signing of the Merger Agreement?



2022 Study:
0-50 Days: 8
50-100 Days: 13
100-200 Days: 18
More Than 200 Days: 6

Source: Public filings.

04 APPENDICES

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APPENDICES

Transaction Details

Transaction Details

Date Announced	Status	Target	Acquiror Name(s)	TV (\$mil)	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums		
					TV/ Revenue	TV/ EBITDA	TV/ EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	1-Month
12/18/2023	Closed	Alteryx, Inc.	Insight Venture Management, LLC; Clearlake Capital Group, L.P.	\$4,392.9	4.77x	NM	NM	62.3%	65.2%	56.3%
12/11/2023	Announced	HireRight Holdings Corporation	General Atlantic Service Company, L.P.; Stone Point Capital LLC	\$1,840.4	2.55x	11.7x	23.8x	50.7%	52.3%	50.1%
11/29/2023	Closed	Rover Group, Inc.	Blackstone Management Partners L.L.C.	\$2,151.8	9.88x	164.3x	NM	29.4%	28.4%	68.5%
11/24/2023	Announced	Fathom Digital Manufacturing Corporation	CORE Industrial Partners, LLC	\$361.5	2.59x	26.5x	NM	7.2%	3.5%	39.7%
10/23/2023	Closed	EngageSmart, Inc.	Vista Equity Partners Management, LLC	\$3,523.3	9.67x	73.6x	151.7x	24.7%	29.9%	27.5%
09/28/2023	Closed	Chico's FAS, Inc.	Sycamore Partners Management, L.P.	\$1,389.8	0.65x	3.8x	9.9x	64.9%	66.3%	46.7%
09/06/2023	Closed	NextGen Healthcare, Inc.	Thoma Bravo, L.P.	\$1,763.8	2.60x	30.3x	37.5x	48.2%	43.0%	48.2%
08/28/2023	Closed	Thorne HealthTech, Inc.	L Catterton Partners	\$729.5	2.83x	30.3x	52.5x	30.6%	22.2%	72.0%
08/28/2023	Closed	Hersha Hospitality Trust	KSL Advisors, LLC	\$1,290.1	3.45x	13.7x	40.7x	59.2%	53.4%	60.0%
08/09/2023	Closed	Avid Technology, Inc.	Symphony Technology Group, LLC	\$1,432.7	3.37x	27.3x	36.5x	0.4%	17.2%	0.8%

EBIT refers to Earnings Before Interest and Taxes.

EBITDA refers to Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation, and Amortization.

LTM refers to Latest 12 Months.

NM refers to Not Meaningful.

TV refers to Transaction Value.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.



Transaction Details (cont.)

Date Announced	Status	Target	Acquiror Name(s)	TV (\$mil)	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums		
					TV/ Revenue	TV/ EBITDA	TV/ EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	1-Month
08/07/2023	Closed	Veritiv Corporation	Clayton, Dubilier & Rice, LLC	\$2,896.5	0.45x	5.5x	7.1x	20.4%	21.3%	36.4%
07/31/2023	Closed	New Relic, Inc.	TPG Capital, L.P.; Francisco Partners Management, L.P.	\$6,597.3	6.93x	NM	NM	66.1%	67.3%	77.8%
07/21/2023	Closed	Chase Corporation	KKR & Co. Inc.	\$1,330.4	3.39x	13.6x	20.4x	2.5%	1.8%	14.2%
07/19/2023	Closed	Heritage-Crystal Clean, Inc.	J.F. Lehman and Company, LLC	\$1,321.8	1.65x	7.2x	13.5x	6.8%	10.0%	23.7%
07/18/2023	Closed	Startek, Inc.	Capital Square Partners Pte Ltd	\$249.9	0.68x	4.2x	12.4x	49.8%	50.9%	45.8%
06/06/2023	Closed	Paratek Pharmaceuticals, Inc.	Novo Holdings A/S; Gurnet Point Capital Limited	\$399.2	2.40x	NM	NM	53.1%	93.5%	72.4%
06/05/2023	Closed	CIRCOR International, Inc.	KKR & Co. Inc.	\$1,663.1	2.02x	12.1x	21.8x	97.1%	91.9%	111.2%
05/10/2023	Closed	Syneos Health, Inc.	Veritas Capital Fund Management, L.L.C.; Elliott Investment Management L.P.; Patient Square Capital, LP	\$7,377.4	1.36x	9.7x	17.8x	18.9%	14.4%	23.2%
05/04/2023	Closed	Arconic Corporation	Apollo Global Management, Inc.; Irenic Capital Management LP	\$4,671.0	0.54x	8.1x	15.8x	35.6%	35.4%	27.6%
04/17/2023	Closed	Charah Solutions, Inc.	SER Capital Partners	\$331.4	1.11x	NM	NM	57.3%	206.1%	54.6%

EBIT refers to Earnings Before Interest and Taxes.

EBITDA refers to Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation, and Amortization.

LTM refers to Latest 12 Months.

NM refers to Not Meaningful.

TV refers to Transaction Value.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.



Transaction Details (cont.)

Date	Announced	Status	Target	Acquiror Name(s)	TV (\$mil)	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums		
						TV/ Revenue	TV/ EBITDA	TV/ EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	1-Month
04/13/2023	Announced	Consolidated Communications Holdings, Inc.	British Columbia Investment Management Corporation; Searchlight Capital Partners, L.P.		\$2,661.6	2.35x	9.4x	NM	62.1%	76.7%	85.8%
04/12/2023	Closed	TESSCO Technologies Incorporated	Lee Equity Partners, LLC; Twin Point Capital LLC		\$162.9	0.36x	81.3x	NM	74.1%	69.8%	42.2%
03/30/2023	Closed	Greenlight Biosciences Holdings Pbc	Fall Line Capital, LLC		\$90.6	8.76x	NM	NM	-35.4% *	-40.8% *	-37.5% *
03/20/2023	Closed	Franchise Group, Inc.	Senior Management		\$3,790.5	0.86x	5.8x	13.0x	31.9%	15.8%	-0.2% *
03/14/2023	Closed	Cvent Holding Corp.	Blackstone Inc.; Abu Dhabi Investment Authority		\$4,577.1	7.26x	NM	NM	24.3%	34.9%	57.4%
03/14/2023	Closed	Univar Solutions Inc.	Apollo Global Management, Inc.; Abu Dhabi Investment Authority		\$8,112.5	0.71x	7.3x	9.4x	25.0%	23.2%	44.0%
03/13/2023	Closed	Momentive Global Inc.	Symphony Technology Group, LLC		\$1,561.0	3.25x	NM	NM	26.1%	9.6%	18.0%
03/12/2023	Closed	Qualtrics International Inc.	Silver Lake Technology Management, L.L.C.; Canada Pension Plan Investment Board		\$10,910.9	7.48x	NM	NM	59.8%	69.8%	87.5%
03/01/2023	Closed	Radius Global Infrastructure, Inc.	Public Sector Pension Investment Board; EQT AB (publ); EQT Active Core Infrastructure		\$3,000.0	NA	NA	NA	23.6%	12.3%	11.5%
02/09/2023	Closed	Sumo Logic, Inc.	Francisco Partners Management, L.P.		\$1,397.4	4.65x	NM	NM	61.3%	54.5%	53.3%

EBIT refers to Earnings Before Interest and Taxes.

EBITDA refers to Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation, and Amortization.

LTM refers to Latest 12 Months.

NM refers to Not Meaningful.

NA refers to Not Available.

TV refers to Transaction Value.

*Excluded from the range.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.



Transaction Details (cont.)

Date Announced	Status	Target	Acquiror Name(s)	TV (\$mil)	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums		
					TV/ Revenue	TV/ EBITDA	TV/ EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	1-Month
02/09/2023	Closed	Berkshire Grey, Inc.	SoftBank Group Corp.	\$319.7	4.85x	NM	NM	-22.2%	* 3.7%	55.1%
01/31/2023	Closed	Atlas Technical Consultants, Inc.	GI Manager L.P.	\$979.2	1.62x	13.9x	25.4x	123.9%	123.9%	137.9%
01/09/2023	Closed	Disco Parent, Inc.	Vista Equity Partners Management, LLC	\$2,368.9	7.64x	233.9x	NM	46.3%	57.7%	61.6%

Low ⁽¹⁾	\$90.6	0.36x	3.8x	7.1x	0.4%	1.8%	0.8%
High ⁽¹⁾	\$10,910.9	9.88x	233.9x	151.7x	123.9%	206.1%	137.9%
Median ⁽¹⁾	\$1,663.1	2.60x	12.8x	20.4x	46.3%	39.2%	50.1%
Mean ⁽¹⁾	\$2,595.3	3.52x	36.1x	30.0x	43.3%	47.7%	52.0%

⁽¹⁾ Calculation excludes negative premiums and other outliers.

EBIT refers to Earnings Before Interest and Taxes.

EBITDA refers to Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation, and Amortization.

LTM refers to Latest 12 Months.

NM refers to Not Meaningful.

TV refers to Transaction Value.

*Excluded from the range.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.



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APPENDICES

2022 Going Private Transaction Study Summary

2022 Transaction Analysis by Target Company Size

- Eighteen (40.0%) of the transactions in the Study had a transaction value in excess of \$5.0 billion, with eight (17.8%) transactions in excess of \$10.0 billion.
- Transaction values in 2022, on average, are materially higher than transaction values in recent previous years.
 - For the calendar years ended December 31, 2019, and December 31, 2020, there were a total of 32 going private transactions with a median and average TV of \$1,706.7 million and \$2,940.2 million, respectively.

Analysis by Target Company Size

(Dollars in Millions)

Transaction Value	Number of Transactions		TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
				TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1-Day	1-Week	4-Weeks
Over \$10.0 billion	8	Median	\$14,782.1	11.2x	26.1x	36.7x	18.2%	14.4%	23.4%
		Mean	\$20,014.1	10.6x	25.1x	44.7x	18.7%	16.3%	30.0%
\$5.0 billion to \$10.0 billion	10	Median	\$7,294.6	8.5x	15.4x	34.7x	33.7%	39.0%	47.6%
		Mean	\$7,365.3	8.1x	15.0x	32.3x	48.0%	46.4%	50.0%
\$1.0 billion to \$5.0 billion	13	Median	\$1,999.0	3.2x	15.3x	19.6x	43.9%	37.5%	31.1%
		Mean	\$2,428.9	5.2x	37.3x	24.7x	40.2%	42.9%	39.6%
Less than \$1.0 billion	14	Median	\$260.9	3.8x	17.7x	51.8x	81.1%	83.8%	83.7%
		Mean	\$358.1	5.0x	18.9x	70.0x	79.7%	82.3%	78.7%
All Transactions	45	Median	\$2,796.3	5.2x	16.8x	36.8x	34.0%	38.4%	46.3%
		Mean	\$6,007.9	7.1x	25.1x	43.7x	51.2%	52.0%	52.4%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.

2022 Transaction Analysis by Date Announced

- Transaction volume peaked in Q2 2022, while the other quarters remained consistently active.
- Transaction values were meaningfully higher in the first two quarters as compared to the last two quarters.
- Average implied multiples and acquisition premiums generally increased throughout the year, with the highest average acquisition premiums observed in Q4 2022.

Analysis by Transaction Announcement Date

(Dollars in Millions)

Transaction Date	Number of Transactions		TV	LTM Multiples			Acquisition Premiums ⁽¹⁾		
				TV/Revenue	TV/EBITDA	TV/EBIT	1 Day	1 Week	4 Weeks
1/1/2022 – 3/31/2022	8	Median	\$7,277.0	4.2x	15.3x	30.1x	26.1%	39.2%	45.0%
		Mean	\$8,904.8	5.7x	14.8x	31.5x	37.6%	43.2%	44.8%
4/1/2022 – 6/30/2022	17	Median	\$1,939.0	5.4x	22.4x	36.8x	28.6%	29.6%	38.5%
		Mean	\$8,142.1	7.5x	22.9x	43.3x	39.5%	40.8%	43.9%
7/1/2022 – 9/30/2022	10	Median	\$2,154.7	9.1x	14.2x	19.6x	45.5%	39.1%	41.4%
		Mean	\$3,683.5	7.2x	41.2x	45.1x	63.5%	58.2%	52.5%
10/1/2022 – 12/31/2022	10	Median	\$1,276.3	8.0x	22.5x	76.4x	66.2%	71.4%	69.0%
		Mean	\$2,386.5	8.0x	22.5x	76.4x	69.5%	70.9%	72.2%
All Transactions	45	Median	\$2,796.3	5.2x	16.8x	36.3x	34.0%	38.4%	46.3%
		Mean	\$6,007.9	7.1x	25.1x	43.0x	51.2%	52.0%	52.4%

Notes: The high and low metrics shown in this chart represent the high and low TVs, TV multiples, and acquisition premiums shown in the study. The low TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest transaction value, and the high TV multiples and acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the highest transaction value. Similarly, the low and high acquisition premiums, respectively, are not necessarily associated with the transactions with the lowest and highest transaction value or TV multiples.

(1) Calculation excludes negative premiums.

Source: S&P Capital IQ.

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APPENDICES

Introduction to Houlihan Lokey

Houlihan Lokey is the trusted advisor to more top decision-makers than any other independent global investment bank

CORPORATE FINANCE

2023 M&A Advisory Rankings
All Global Transactions

Advisor	Deals
1 Houlihan Lokey	352
2 Rothschild & Co	349
3 Goldman Sachs & Co	300
3 JP Morgan	300
5 Morgan Stanley	253

Source: LSEG (formerly Refinitiv).
Excludes accounting firms and brokers.

No. 1
Global M&A Advisor

No. 1
U.S. M&A Advisor

Leading
Capital Markets Advisor

FINANCIAL RESTRUCTURING

2023 Global Distressed Debt &
Bankruptcy Restructuring Rankings

Advisor	Deals
1 Houlihan Lokey	73
2 PJT Partners Inc	64
3 Rothschild & Co	51
4 Lazard	37
5 Evercore Partners	27

Source: LSEG (formerly Refinitiv).

No. 1
Global Restructuring Advisor

1,700+
Transactions Completed Valued at
More Than **\$3.5 Trillion** Collectively

FINANCIAL AND VALUATION ADVISORY

1999–2023 Global M&A
Fairness Advisory Rankings

Advisor	Deals
1 Houlihan Lokey	1,247
2 JP Morgan	1,035
3 Duff & Phelps, A Kroll Business	977
4 UBS	884
5 Morgan Stanley	716

Source: LSEG (formerly Refinitiv).
Announced or completed transactions.

No. 1
Global M&A Fairness Opinion
Advisor Over the Past **25 Years**

2,000+
Annual Valuation Engagements



Our product knowledge, industry expertise,
and global reach deliver superior results

PRODUCT EXPERTISE



Corporate
Finance



Financial
Restructuring



Financial and
Valuation Advisory

DEDICATED INDUSTRY GROUPS

Business Services

Consumer, Food, and Retail

Energy

Financial Services

FinTech

Healthcare

Industrials

Real Estate, Lodging, and Leisure

Technology

KEY FACTS AND FIGURES

36

Locations Worldwide

2,660

Global Employees

312

Managing Directors⁽¹⁾

\$1.8B

Revenue⁽²⁾

\$8.8B

Market Capitalization⁽³⁾



(1) As of December 31, 2023; excludes corporate MDs.

(2) LTM ended December 31, 2023.

(3) As of March 31, 2024.



Overview of Financial Sponsors Group

Houlihan Lokey has one of the largest Financial Sponsors groups focused on mid- and large-cap funds. In the past five years, more than 730 private equity firms have chosen Houlihan Lokey to advise on M&A or capital raising for their portfolio companies.

Financial Sponsors Group

Importance of Sponsors	Houlihan Lokey has sold over 280 companies to financial sponsors in 2023
Broad and Deep Financial Sponsor Coverage Group	- Houlihan Lokey has 29 senior officers dedicated to the sponsor community in the Americas and Europe - Coverage of 1,300+ private equity firms, 300+ credit funds, and 70+ family offices - Organized geographically to ensure client coverage proximity
High-Quality Relationships	171 closed M&A transactions in 2023 (with sponsors) 135 FRG transactions worked on in 2023 (with sponsors) 1,700+ FVA engagements worked on in 2023 (with sponsors) - Provide financial sponsors access to successful solutions—with coverage officers facilitating two-way information flow between the sponsors and Houlihan Lokey
Unparalleled Data on Buyer Behavior	- Knowledge of, and database on, financial sponsor preferences and behavior through our relationships and deal flow - Collect and analyze comprehensive data on industry, size, and general market trends

Deep Relationships Across Fund Sizes and Types

ARDIAN

Bregal
Unternehmerkapital

Bridgepoint

ARES

capiton

capvis

BainCapital

CARLYLE

CASTIK CAPITAL

Cinven

COURT SQUARE

CVC

Deutsche Beteiligungs AG

DEUTSCHE PRIVATE EQUITY

IEQT

EQUISTONE

GENERAL ATLANTIC

HELLMAN & FRIEDMAN

Hg

H.I.G. CAPITAL

Investment Partners

KKR

LDC
BACKING AMBITION

MARLIN EQUITY PARTNERS

NEW MOUNTAIN CAPITAL

PERMIRA

Riverside

TA ASSOCIATES

THOMA BRAVO

VERITAS CAPITAL

VISTA EQUITY PARTNERS

VITRUVIAN PARTNERS

Deep Expertise in Conflict-Prone Situations

Selected Related-Party and 13E-3 Transaction Fairness Opinion Engagements

 has been acquired by funds managed by  Financial Advisor	 has merged with a wholly-owned subsidiary of Turning Point Brands Financial Advisor	 has eliminated its incentive distribution rights through the issuance of common units to  Financial Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has amended its Amended and Restated Exhibitor Services Agreements with Cinemark USA, Inc. and Regal Cinemas, Inc. Financial Advisor	 has been acquired by  Financial Advisor	 has been taken private by Clyde B. Anderson on behalf of the Anderson family We served as financial advisor and rendered a fairness opinion to the Special Committee of BAMM's Board of Directors Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by  Financial Advisor	 has merged with  Financial Advisor
 has merged with  Fairness Opinion	 holder of certain patents acquired from  has merged with  Fairness Opinion	 has purchased 34 dry bulk vessels and certain other assets from  Fairness Opinion	 a portfolio company of  has converted approximately \$498 million of PIK Loans into newly issued common equity and subordinated notes Fairness Opinion	 has acquired a 14.4% interest in  Fairness Opinion	 has agreed to repurchase 15,000,000 shares of its common stock from certain shareholders Fairness Opinion	 has agreed to repurchase 17,452,958 shares of its common stock from certain shareholders Fairness Opinion	 has raised \$92 million from unaffiliated investors, management and  Fairness Opinion
 has been acquired by a consortium led by Yongye's Chairman and CEO, Morgan Stanley Private Equity Asia, Lead Rich International and Full Alliance International Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by Flora Bloom Holdings Limited Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 each a portfolio company of SCF Partners have combined to form  Fairness Opinions	 has been acquired and taken private by affiliates of  Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by Halogen Limited and Halogen Mergersub Limited Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by a consortium led by ChinaEdu's Chairman and CEO and McGraw-Hill Education Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by a consortium led by Sino Gas' Chairman and CEO, Morgan Stanley Private Equity Asia and Zhongyu Gas Holdings Ltd. Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	Steel Excel Inc. has announced the acquisition of  from BNS Holding, Inc. Financial Advisor
 has been acquired by a wholly-owned subsidiary of  Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by  ONCAP II, L.P. Sellside Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has been taken private by TAS Holdings, Inc. and Owl Creek Management, LP Fairness Opinion	 has completed a recapitalization transaction with  Financial Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has agreed to a debt-for-equity exchange with PAR Investment Partners, LP and has issued equity securities to  Financial Advisor & Fairness Opinion	 has raised \$187.5 million through the exercise of an amended warrant owned by  Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by Mustang Group LLC in a going private transaction Fairness Opinion	 has been acquired by  Fairness Opinion

Tombstones included herein represent transactions closed from 2005 forward.

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APPENDICES

Selected Professional Biographies



Richard De Rose

Senior Advisor

NEW YORK

QUALIFICATIONS

University of Pennsylvania
B.A.

Brown University
Ph.D.

New York University
J.D.

Bear, Stearns & Co.
Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz
PAST

Mr. De Rose is a member of Houlihan Lokey's Financial and Valuation Advisory business, where his primary responsibilities include providing investment banking, valuation, and transactional opinion services. He is a member of the firm's Fairness, Solvency, and Technical Standards committees. With over three decades of investment banking experience, Mr. De Rose has extensive expertise in successfully managing complex transactions across a broad spectrum of industries.

Before joining Houlihan Lokey, Mr. De Rose served as Managing Director in the M&A Group of Bear, Stearns & Co. Inc. In that capacity, he advised clients in negotiated M&A, divestitures, leveraged buyouts, contested takeovers, and proxy fights—completing more than 200 M&A transactions. In addition, he was a Managing Director in Bear Stearns' Financial Restructuring Group, advising debtors, senior lenders, bondholders, and prospective acquirers of Chapter 11 debtors and other financially distressed companies. He also served as a member of Bear Stearns' Valuation Committee.

Mr. De Rose began his career as a corporate attorney at Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz. His responsibilities there included providing counsel to clients in M&A transactions and public and private securities offerings, as well as advising banks and institutional investors in connection with debt financings and troubled loan workouts.

Mr. De Rose earned a B.A. in Philosophy from the University of Pennsylvania, a Ph.D. in Philosophy from Brown University, and a J.D. from the New York University School of Law. He is currently a member of the Mergers & Acquisitions Committee of the American Bar Association and the American Bankruptcy Institute. Mr. De Rose is a member of the Corporation Law Committee and a former member of the M&A Committee of the New York City Bar Association. He is also the past Chairman of the Corporation Law Committee of the New York State Bar Association (NYSBA) and a member of the Executive Committee of the Business Law Section of the NYSBA. Mr. De Rose has been qualified as an expert in valuation by the Delaware Chancery Court.



Matt Kavney

Vice President

ATLANTA

QUALIFICATIONS

Georgia Institute of Technology

B.S.

Wells Fargo Securities

PAST

Mr. Kavney is a member of Houlihan Lokey's Board and Special Committee Advisory and Transaction Opinions practices within the firm's Financial and Valuation Advisory business. He primarily advises boards of directors, special committees, general partners, and other stakeholders in evaluating transaction proposals as well as understanding critical deal-related issues.

Mr. Kavney is experienced in providing fairness, solvency, and other transaction opinions to public and private clients on reverse mergers, take-privates, spin-offs, recapitalizations, and securities issuances across a variety of industries. He has substantial experience analyzing transactions, including conflict-prone situations involving issues of corporate governance.

Before joining Houlihan Lokey, Mr. Kavney was awarded an investment banking summer analyst position at Wells Fargo Securities.

Mr. Kavney graduated with highest honors from the Georgia Institute of Technology, earning a B.S. in Mechanical Engineering and a Certificate of Finance. He is a current member of the board of directors of the Georgia Tech Alumni Association.



Gretta Conrath

Associate

CHICAGO

QUALIFICATIONS

University of Wisconsin–Madison

B.B.A.

Certified Public Accountant

OTHER

Deloitte

PAST

Ms. Conrath is a member of Houlihan Lokey’s Financial and Valuation Advisory business. Her experience includes fairness opinions, solvency opinions, ESOP-related transactions, and general business valuation.

Before joining Houlihan Lokey, Ms. Conrath worked as a Senior Consultant in Deloitte’s investment management tax practice.

Ms. Conrath graduated with distinction and honors from the University of Wisconsin–Madison with a B.B.A. in Accounting and Information Systems and a concentration in French. She is a Certified Public Accountant in the state of Illinois.

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APPENDICES

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